TOPIC REPORTS: DIGITAL PAYMENTS AND FINTECH

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News, Sep – Oct 2026

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Algeria

DJEZZY PAYMENT SERVICES

- **Banque d'Algérie : Djezzy Payment Services autorisée à se constituer en PSP** — Algerie Eco, 23 September 2026

  The Bank of Algeria's Monetary and Banking Council authorised Djezzy Payment Services, a subsidiary of Optimum Telecom Algérie, to be set up as a payment service provider under regulation 25-02. The company must apply for a full licence within 12 months of notification.

- **Communiqué du Conseil Monétaire et Bancaire (23 septembre 2026) — autorisation de constitution de Djezzy Payment Services en Prestataire de Services de Paiement** — Banque d'Algérie, 23 September 2026

  The Bank of Algeria's Monetary and Banking Council authorised Djezzy Payment Services, a subsidiary of the mobile operator Optimum Telecom Algérie, to be set up as a payment service provider, its communiqué of 23 September 2026 states. The firm must apply for the bank's approval to operate within twelve months.

- **Djezzy Payment Services autorisée à devenir PSP : la Banque d'Algérie accélère la bataille contre le cash** — Eco Times, 24 September 2026

  The Bank of Algeria's Monetary and Banking Council authorised Djezzy Payment Services, a subsidiary of the mobile operator, to form a payment service provider, announced on 23 September 2026. It has twelve months to apply for the licence it needs to operate. Payment accounts under the rules are capped at 100,000, 500,000 or 1,000,000 dinars depending on the level of identity verification.

- **Paiement électronique : Djezzy décroche le ok de la B.A** — Le Provincial, 24 September 2026

  Algeria's Monetary and Banking Council authorised Djezzy Payment Services, a subsidiary of Optimum Telecom Algérie, to be set up as a payment services provider under monetary law 23-09, the Bank of Algeria announced on 23 September 2026. The firm must apply for a full licence within 12 months.

Angola

RENMINBI CLEARING ARRANGEMENT BETWEEN BAI AND BANK OF CHINA

- **BAI e Bank of China assinam acordo para pagamentos transfronteiricos** — ANGOP, 8 September 2026

  Angola's Banco Angolano de Investimentos (BAI) signed a memorandum of understanding with Bank of China in Xiamen on 8 September 2026 on renminbi clearing. It provides for an RMB clearing account and for BAI's indirect membership of China's Cross-Border Interbank Payment System (CIPS) through Bank of China. No sum is stated.

- **BAI reforca pagamentos em renminbi e cooperacao com a China** — Mercado, 8 September 2026

  Angola's Banco Angolano de Investimentos signed a memorandum with Bank of China's Luanda branch on 8 September 2026 to open a renminbi clearing account and develop renminbi settlement services. Bank of China will support BAI's indirect access to China's Cross-Border Interbank Payment System, aimed at Angolan firms trading with China. No value, start date or expected volume is given.

AFRIMONEY WALLET USERS

- **Operadora de telefonia quer combater enchentes em ATM com "Afrimoney"** — OPAÍS, 10 September 2026

  Africell's Afrimoney wallet in Angola, licensed by the national bank as a payment service provider, has 3 million users among the operator's 8 million subscribers, its commercial manager Rodrigo Conceição said at the Benguela International Fair. The wallet now allows transfers to any bank account, and Africell presents agent cash-out as a way to cut ATM queues on civil-service paydays.

INSTANT PAYMENT SCHEME

- **Movimentos entre carteiras digitais valem apenas 0,6% no Kwik** — Expansão, 21 September 2026

  Transfers between digital wallets were only 0.6% (Kz 3.1 billion) of the Kz 557.4 billion that passed through Angola's Kwik instant-payment system in the first half of 2026, according to EMIS data. Wallets sent about 38% of the value, nearly all of it to bank accounts, while banks sent about 62%, and only Kz 2.8 billion of that went to non-bank providers. Only the free opening of the article is held.

- **África já tem 36 sistemas de pagamentos instantâneos, o próximo desafio é fazê-los conversar** — FinTechs, 8 October 2026 KENYA AFRICA

  Africa has 36 active instant payment systems in 31 countries, which processed more than 64 billion transactions worth nearly US$2 trillion in 2024, according to an AfricaNenda, World Bank and UN Economic Commission for Africa report cited by FinTechs. Angola's KWiK service processed 4.48 million transfers worth 123.85 billion kwanzas in August 2026, up 53.3% in a year.

Benin

MANDATORY ELECTRONIC PAYMENT OF COURT AND CHANCELLERY FEES

- **Décret n° 2026-617 du 18 septembre 2026 portant modalités de tarification des actes délivrés à la chancellerie et dans les juridictions et instituant le paiement en ligne obligatoire** — Présidence de la République du Bénin (Secrétariat général du Gouvernement), 18 September 2026

  Benin now requires fees for documents issued by the courts and the justice chancellery, tax stamps included, to be paid electronically. The decree leaves the tariff to a joint Justice and Finance arrêté, sends receipts to a dedicated Treasury account and repeals the 2012 uniform-fee decree.

- **Tarification des actes : Les coûts des actes délivrés par les juridictions fixés par arrêté interministériel** — Fraternité, 16 October 2026

Benin's finance and justice ministers set fees for 109 documents issued by the courts and the justice ministry, now payable only online. A criminal-record extract costs FCFA 1,900 and a naturalisation application FCFA 50,000.

TAX E-SERVICES FOR SMALL-BUSINESS TAX CENTRES OUTSIDE COTONOU

- **Bénin : l'impôt en ligne arrive à Parakou, Comè et Lokossa** — Bénin Web TV, 18 September 2026

  Benin's tax directorate is opening its online declaration and payment platform to the small-business tax centres of Parakou from 21 September, Comè from 28 September and Lokossa from 5 October.

SEMO OFFICIAL-MISSIONS SYSTEM AND ELECTRONIC PAYMENT OF MISSION EXPENSES

- **Finances publiques : Une nouvelle étape franchie dans la digitalisation du paiement des frais de mission** — Gouvernement de la République du Bénin, 25 September 2026

  Benin's finance ministry made electronic payment of official mission expenses mandatory across public administrations by a circular of 25 September 2026. This is the second phase, SEMO 2, of the mission-management platform run by the national control directorate, whose first phase was used to detect overlapping missions and fictitious staff. Geolocated proof of mission is to follow.

- **SEMO+ : La preuve de mission entre dans l'ère du numérique !** — Gouvernement de la République du Bénin, 3 October 2026

  Benin's government announced on 3 October 2026 that public servants on official missions now prove their presence through the SEMO+ mobile app. They log in with their personal identification number, select the mission, share their location and confirm by fingerprint; biometric kiosks in some public places offer an alternative.

Botswana

FNBB EWALLET TRANSFERS INTO MOBILE-MONEY WALLETS

- **FNBB muscles into mobile money race** — Mmegi, 14 September 2026

  First National Bank Botswana will let customers receiving money through its eWallet service transfer it directly to Orange Money, Mascom's MyZaka and BTC's Smega. The bank announced the plan with results for the year to June 2026, showing profit before tax up 12 per cent to P2.12 billion. No launch date is given.

GOOGLE PAY ON ABSA BANK BOTSWANA CARDS

- **Absa Botswana's Google Pay, Bringing contactless payments to a nation still reaching for them** — Weekend Post, 21 September 2026

  Absa Bank Botswana has made Google Pay available on Android for its Visa debit, credit and multi-currency virtual cards, with no extra fees. The launch date was not given. The service only works where merchants have NFC terminals, and the report says these are patchy outside Gaborone and Francistown.

Burkina Faso

CERTIFIED ELECTRONIC INVOICE

- **Communiqué | Facture électronique certifiée : la mise en vente des systèmes de facturation démarre le 7 septembre 2026 au Burkina Faso** — Burkina24 (communiqué DGI / CCI-BF), 1 September 2026

> Certified electronic invoicing systems go on sale in Burkina Faso from 7 September 2026 for large and medium enterprises, under the general tax code — the point at which the invoicing regime becomes equipment a business has to buy.

> INSURANCE SUBSCRIPTION AND PREMIUM PAYMENT THROUGH ORANGE MONEY

- **Au Burkina Faso, l'assureur SONAR mise sur Orange Money pour numériser ses services** — wearetech.africa, 21 September 2026

  Insurer SONAR Assurance and Orange Money Burkina Faso signed a partnership in Ouagadougou on 18 September 2026 so clients can take out policies, pay premiums and check their contracts by phone. Orange Money says it has about 100,000 points of sale in the country. The exact terms of access have not yet been set.

> MAX IT SUPER-APP (ORANGE BURKINA FASO)

- **Orange Burkina Faso lance la nouvelle version de son application « Max It »** — Burkina24, 21 September 2026

  Orange Burkina Faso relaunched its Max It app on 18 September 2026 with a promotional caravan through four cities. The new version adds messaging and TV to mobile money, calls and SMS, and is open to customers of other networks. It links to almost all the country's banks for transfers to wallets, and takes water and electricity bills and public charges such as the vehicle tax.

Burundi

> EAC REGIONAL CROSS-BORDER PAYMENT SYSTEM MASTER PLAN

- **Regional lawmakers flag unfinished Burundi Payment Systems Work as grant closes** — Burundi Times, 10 October 2026

  The East African Legislative Assembly's accounts committee reported that Burundi left parts of the regional payment-systems integration project unfinished when its grant closed in June. It recommends an audit and a costed completion plan; the central bank says it still intends to join the East African Payment System by December.

Cameroon

> AVAILABILITY OF PAPSS TO CAMEROONIAN BUSINESSES

- **Intégration financière : la BEAC et le PAPSS mobilisent les banques de la CEMAC** — Journal du Cameroun, 9 September 2026 CENTRAL AFRICA

  The Bank of Central African States (BEAC) and the Pan-African Payment and Settlement System (PAPSS) held a webinar on 9 September 2026 to bring commercial banks of the CEMAC zone onto the continental payment system, following BEAC's own accession. The session covered terms of participation and next steps; no timetable or number of banks is given.

> MAX IT SUPER APP CARRYING ORANGE MONEY

- **Max it : Orange Cameroun peut-il transformer sa Super App en référence du numérique ?** — KamerAndroid, 10 September 2026

  Orange Cameroon has closed its Orange Money Afrique app and moved its mobile money services into Max it, an app that also handles line management, bill payments, a marketplace and entertainment. On 24 August the Max it team apologised to users for system errors that blocked some operations after an update. The app carries a 3.7 out of 5 rating on Google Play from about 47,800 reviews.

KONOOM MOBILE MONEY PAYMENT INSTITUTION

- **Cameroun : Konoom obtient son agrément et se lance sur le marché du paiement mobile** — Agence Ecofin, 17 September 2026

  Cameroon has licensed Konoom Cameroun as its third payment institution, after Orange Money and MTN's Mobile Money Corporation, by finance ministry order 681 of 21 July 2026, announced on 17 September. Konoom plans transfers, bill and tax payments and merchant payments by phone. It has operated in Chad since December 2025.

REASY AND AGL PAYMENT AND LOGISTICS PILOT FOR IMPORTS FROM CHINA

- **Cameroon's REasy and AGL Pilot Digital Payment and Logistics Service for China Imports** — Business Tech Africa, 6 October 2026

  Cameroonian fintech REasy and Africa Global Logistics presented to Douala traders on 1 October 2026 a pilot service for small businesses importing from China. REasy converts CFA francs to yuan to pay suppliers through Alipay, WeChat Pay or Chinese bank accounts, while AGL consolidates and ships goods. The first shared container reached Douala on 29 April; no pricing has been published.

Cape Verde

REDE VINTI4 NATIONAL RETAIL PAYMENT SWITCH

- **Quase 5 milhões de operações na rede Vinti4 em Agosto** — Expresso das Ilhas, 14 September 2026

  The Banco de Cabo Verde reported on 14 September 2026 that residents made 4,992,880 operations worth 21,159.9 million escudos on the vinti4 card network in August, down 0.3% in number and 2.4% in value on July. Card purchases made up 3,768,595 operations. The interbank clearing system processed 131,456 operations worth 25,543.1 million escudos, down 19.1% in number.

Central African Republic

MOBILE MONEY SERVICE POINTS IN INTERIOR LOCALITIES (DIGITAL GOVERNANCE PROJECT)

- **Avis d'appel d'offres N°015/MFB/PGNSP/COORDO/SPM/26 — Appui au développement des points de services mobile money dans les localités de l'intérieur de la République Centrafricaine (World Bank notice OP00475730)** — World Bank (procurement notice, borrower: Ministère des Finances et du Budget, République Centrafricaine), 16 October 2026

  A World Bank procurement notice dated 16 October 2026 invites bids for kits to set up mobile-money agent points in the interior of the Central African Republic. The goods tender, under the Public Sector Digital Governance Project, has an estimated value of USD 200,000 and a bid deadline of 13 November 2026.

- **Open tender — CAR- Public Sector Digital Governance Project: Acquisition des Kits pour la mise en place d'agent de monnaie mobile — for Central African Republic by WB in ICT & Telecommunications sector —** — DevelopmentAid, 19 October 2026

  The Central African Republic opened an invitation for bids on 19 October 2026 for goods: kits to set up mobile money agents. The tender falls under the World Bank-financed Public Sector Digital Governance Project. No budget is stated and no award has been made.

POST CASH NATIONAL FINTECH PLATFORM

- **ELABORATION DU CAHIER DE CHARGE FONCTIONNEL ET TECHNIQUE PLATE FORME FINTEC** — United Nations Development Programme (UNDP) via UNGM, 16 October 2026

> UNDP in the Central African Republic is seeking an individual consultant to write the functional and technical specification for POST CASH, a national fintech platform. The contract is 30 working days over two months in Bangui, and bids close on 25 October 2026.

Chad

> ELECTRONIC MONEY PROVIDERS AND THEIR FEES

- **Monnaie électronique : entre engouement, frais élevés et espoir de concurrence** — Tchadinfos, 4 September 2026

  Chad's electronic money market now has four providers, with Konoom, described as the first wholly Chadian fintech, and Nita joining Airtel Money and Moov Money. Users interviewed said sending fees are high and hoped competition would lower them. Active mobile money accounts were roughly 160,000 to 240,000 between 2020 and 2022, depending on the source.

> ELECTRONIC PAYMENT TERMINALS DELIVERED

- **Tchad : la digitalisation de l'administration face au défi de l'électricité et de la connectivité** — Le N'Djam Post, 18 September 2026

  A Chadian analysis finds the state's push to go paperless and cashless under the 2026 finance law, with 3,000 payment terminals in revenue offices and compulsory electronic invoicing, held back by power cuts, thin connectivity in the provinces and some officials' limited digital skills. It also names the integrated public-finance system and a June 2026 awareness campaign; no transaction figures are given.

> STANDARDISED ELECTRONIC INVOICE

- **Facturation électronique : la Commune de N'Djamena met ses fournisseurs face à une nouvelle exigence** — Le N'Djam Post, 29 September 2026

  N'Djamena's city council told suppliers that their invoices must be standardised electronic invoices where they are liable, under a finance ministry circular of 10 September 2026, or risk not being paid.

> STATE POSTAL OPERATOR TRANSFORMATION (POSTAL BANK AND PAYMENT PLATFORM)

- **Tchad : Haliki Choua Mahamat dévoile les grands chantiers de la poste** — Le N'Djam Post, 9 October 2026

  Chad's telecoms minister set out a transformation of the state postal operator: a postal bank in the medium term, an integrated payment platform and post offices as one-stop counters. Its virtual-operator and internet-provider licences are to be put to use; no budget or date was given.

Comoros

> MSAANDA CASH TRANSFERS BY MOBILE BANKING

- **Le Gouvernement comorien élargit la protection sociale à 55 000 ménages vulnérables** — PFSS-RRC (Projet Filets Sociaux de Sécurité, Union des Comores), 21 September 2026

  Comoros began a new phase of its World Bank-funded social cash transfers on 20 September 2026, reaching 55,000 households, 15,000 of them new, with USD 11 million in additional financing. Payments go through the mobile-banking operators Mvula and Huri Money, and households are selected from the unified social registry.

Congo

> YANO PAYMENT AGGREGATION PLATFORM

- **Fintech : Yano se positionne dans la structuration des transactions financières mobiles** — Agence Congolaise d'Information, 29 September 2026

  Yano, a Congolese fintech launched on 14 September 2026, lets groups, traders and individuals collect contributions and take mobile payments by QR code or link, regardless of mobile operator, its co-founder Elwin Gomo told the Congolese news agency. It holds no cash itself. It is backed by the Bantulab programme through a 655 million CFA franc investment vehicle.

Cote d'Ivoire

TREASURY PAYMENTS PLATFORM

- **Connexion des Trésors Publics à la Plateforme Interopérable du Système de Paiement Instantané (PI-SPI) de l'Union Economique et Monétaire Ouest Africaine** — BCEAO, 8 October 2026 WEST AFRICA

  The Central Bank of West African States announced on 8 October 2026 that WAEMU public treasuries are being connected to its PI-SPI instant payment platform, to send and receive salaries, grants, subsidies and taxes whatever the counterpart's account. Côte d'Ivoire's treasury already makes regular bulk payments through it; the others are being integrated progressively.

PUSH PAYMENTS PLATFORM

- **RCI : PUSH veut digitaliser 3 000 Mds F de flux financiers** — APAnews, 15 October 2026

  Ivorian fintech PUSH announced in Abidjan on 15 October 2026 a plan to digitalise up to CFAF 3,000 billion of financial flows. It signed agreements with BNI, Ecobank and Versus Bank to track agricultural value-chain credit, and an interoperability and merchant-payment deal with Orange Money. PUSH reports more than 700,000 individual accounts and over 20 million transactions worth more than CFAF 600 billion.

DR Congo

ROADMAP FOR MODERNISING THE NATIONAL PAYMENTS SYSTEM

- **Le pari de la Banque centrale pour moderniser le système de paiements** — Ouragan, 4 September 2026

  The Central Bank of Congo instructed its technical services to draw up a roadmap for modernising the national payments system, its governor said after a central bank payments conference in Istanbul. The stated aims are the security, fluidity and continuity of transactions and assessing the uses and risks of artificial intelligence, tokenisation, stablecoins and central bank digital currencies; the delegation gave sustained attention to offline payment, given electricity and internet constraints in several parts of the country.

ISYS-REGIES REVENUE COLLECTION PLATFORM

- **Presumee cyber-maffia a la Banque Centrale sur les recettes de la DGI : versions croisees** — Congo Guardian, 10 September 2026

  The Democratic Republic of Congo's tax directorate wrote to the finance minister on 3 September 2026 alleging that central bank staff siphoned tax revenue by manipulating the ISYS-REGIES revenue platform, and sought their suspension and a judicial inquiry. On 10 September the Banque Centrale du Congo denied it, saying every action on the platform is logged and cannot be altered after validation.

- **RDC : la BCC dement toute manipulation des recettes de l'Etat et clarifie les ecarts entre Isys-regies et Navision** — Actualite.cd, 11 September 2026

The Central Bank of Congo denied on 10 September 2026 that state revenue had been deleted or altered in ISYS-RÉGIES, its revenue-collection platform built since 2021 with the French development agency AFD. It said gaps against its NAVISION accounting system mostly involve the savings bank CADECO, which is outside its clearing house, and are settled in a monthly reconciliation. AFD and the finance ministry signed a €12.5 million convention in 2021 to digitise and link the revenue agencies.

MICROFINANCE TRANSITION TO DIGITAL PAYMENTS

- **DRC Microfinance Institutions Seek Digital Support Ahead of Dollar Cash Ban** — BANKABLE, 14 September 2026

  Microfinance institutions in the Democratic Republic of Congo are seeking financial and technical support to move to digital payments before the central bank's ban on US dollar cash transactions takes effect on 9 April 2027. An August 2026 report by the microfinance and savings cooperative associations, ANIMF and APROCEC, with Innogence Consulting, names the deadline as a main constraint for smaller institutions.

PAN-AFRICAN PAYMENT AND SETTLEMENT SYSTEM (PAPSS) ACCESSION

- **EAC, PAPSS, IA : la BCC accélère l'intégration de la RDC dans l'écosystème financier africain** — Actualite.cd, 21 September 2026

  DR Congo joined the Pan-African Payment and Settlement System on 18 September 2026, when the central bank governor, André Wameso, signed the accession agreement in Nairobi. The same day he signed the East African Community central banks' memorandum on currency convertibility and repatriation, which Burundi, Uganda, Tanzania, Kenya and South Sudan had already joined.

NATIONAL CONSUMER COMPLAINTS PLATFORM

- **Communiqué de presse N°163/2026 : le Ministère de l'Économie Nationale lance « LOBA », une plateforme numérique dédiée à la protection des consommateurs** — Ministère de l'Économie Nationale (RDC), Cellule de communication, 5 October 2026

  The Democratic Republic of the Congo's Ministry of National Economy launched LOBA, a national consumer-protection platform, from 6 October 2026. Run through the Competition Commission (COMCO) with sector regulators covering telecoms, banking, insurance, electricity and health, it lets consumers report abuses, learn their rights and track complaints via a WhatsApp chatbot and a mobile app.

Egypt

MOBILE WALLET ACCOUNTS AND VALUE

- **الجهاز القومي لتنظيم الاتصالات يصدر تقرير مؤشرات استخدام المحافظ الإلكترونية التابعة لشركات الاتصالات للنصف الأول لعام 2026** — National Telecom Regulatory Authority (NTRA), Egypt, 9 September 2026

  Egypt's National Telecom Regulatory Authority reported 57.01 million mobile wallets in the first half of 2026, up 23% on a year earlier, with penetration at 45%. Wallets carried 2.22 billion transactions worth EGP 2.96 trillion. Vodafone Cash held 53% of wallets and 77% of transaction value.

- **كيف غيرت المحافظ الإلكترونية عادات الدفع في مصر؟** — Youm7, 14 September 2026

  Egypt's telecom regulator counted 57.01 million operator mobile wallets in the first half of 2026, up 23% in a year, with EGP 2.96 trillion transacted and penetration at 45%. Vodafone Cash held 77% of transaction value, and 67% of wallets were registered to men.

PAN-AFRICAN PAYMENT AND SETTLEMENT SYSTEM, CAIRO HEADQUARTERS

- **Afreximbank plans PAPSS-Instapay link to expand Egypt-Africa cross-border payments** — Ahram Online, 9 September 2026 AFRICA

  The Pan-African Payment and Settlement System plans to connect to Instapay, Egypt's central-bank-licensed instant payment app, its chief executive Mike Ogbalu said at a Cairo conference held 7-9 September 2026. He said six Egyptian banks are awaiting central bank approval to join PAPSS, which operates in 30 African countries.

- **CBE governor participates in 14th meeting of PGC PAPSS in Nairobi** — Egypt State Information Service, 19 September 2026 AFRICA

  The Central Bank of Egypt's governor, Hassan Abdalla, attended the 14th meeting of the Pan-African Payment and Settlement System's governing council in Nairobi on 19 September 2026. The council discussed increasing participation by central and commercial banks and tighter risk controls. Egypt's central bank has been studying the system's technical and legal features so that Egyptian banks can join.

- **CBE Governor: Enhanced Egyptian bank participation drives Pan-African financial integration** — Businessmen EG, 19 September 2026 AFRICA

  The Central Bank of Egypt told the board of governors of the Pan-African Payment and Settlement System that Egyptian banks can now execute and fund cross-border payments with African counterparts directly, without intermediary clearing agents or the US dollar, reported on 19 September 2026. Egypt joined PAPSS in November 2024 and is assessing the PAPSS Card scheme.

- **Central Bank of Egypt Governor discusses African payment network expansion at Nairobi meeting** — Daily News Egypt, 19 September 2026 AFRICA

  Central Bank of Egypt Governor Hassan Abdalla attended the 14th Governing Council meeting of the Pan-African Payment and Settlement System in Nairobi, which discussed adding participating banks and reducing cross-border payment risk. Egypt joined the system in November 2024 and its council in January 2025, and is assessing the PAPSS Card and Marketplace services.

- **InstaPay to connect with pan-African payment system as six Egyptian banks apply for integration** — EnterpriseAM (Egypt), 23 September 2026

  Afreximbank plans to connect the Pan-African Payment and Settlement System (PAPSS) to Egypt's InstaPay, and six unnamed Egyptian banks have applied to the Central Bank of Egypt for integration approval, PAPSS's chief executive said. InstaPay does not yet handle cross-border payments, so a gateway has still to be built; no launch date was given.

YOMO DIGITAL BANK

- **CIB-Backed Yomo Digital Bank Plans Egypt Launch With $300M Investment** — MENA Startup Digest, 14 September 2026

  Yomo, a digital bank being developed by Commercial International Bank Egypt, has preliminary approval from the Central Bank of Egypt, reported on 14 September 2026. Chief executive Roshwan Hamady said up to US$300 million will be invested before a pilot launch, serving individuals, including Egyptians abroad, before small businesses. No approval or launch date is given.

DIGITAL POUND (CENTRAL BANK DIGITAL CURRENCY)

- **The digital EGP won't look different at checkout — but it will work nothing like InstaPay** — EnterpriseAM Egypt, 15 September 2026

A market explainer sets out how a digital pound would differ from existing instant payments and wallets: central bank money held directly rather than a claim on a bank or telco. The central bank is laying ground for a wholesale rollout before any retail use.

INTEGRATION OF THE NATIONAL CARD SCHEME WITH THE CONTINENTAL CARD SCHEME

- **Egypt's Meeza Cards Set for Wider African Use Through PAPSS Integration** — WAYA, 20 September 2026

  AFRICA

  Afreximbank is connecting the continental card scheme to Egypt's Meeza national card network so cards issued on either side work across more African markets. The first phase joins the two infrastructures and establishes a settlement layer; payment would be in the currency of the country being visited, and no availability date was given.

STATE DIGITAL-FINANCE OPERATOR ACQUISITION OF A NON-BANK LENDER

- **e-finance to acquire 99.32% of Tamweely in cash, share swap deal** — Arab Finance, 20 September 2026

  Shareholders of Egypt's e-finance for Digital and Financial Investments approved the acquisition of a 99.32% stake in Tamweely Financial Services, for EGP 956.37 million in cash plus 146.08 million new e-finance shares issued to Tamweely's main shareholder, Turin Egypt. An independent study valued Tamweely at EGP 6.426 billion. The Financial Regulatory Authority approved the deal in August.

INSTANT PAYMENT NETWORK AND INSTAPAY

- **Egypt’s IPN records 1.47 bln transactions worth EGP 4.33 tln in 2Q 2026: CBE governor** — Ahram Online, 1 October 2026

  The Central Bank of Egypt's governor, Hassan Abdalla, told the Council of Arab Central Banks in Abu Dhabi on 29 September 2026 that Egypt's Instant Payment Network had recorded 1.47 billion transactions worth about EGP 4.33tn by the end of the second quarter of 2026, with about 22 million registered customers. The report does not say whether the figures cover the quarter or the network's life to date.

Equatorial Guinea

PRESIDENCY ORDER 3/2025 PROHIBITING CASH COLLECTION OF STATE REVENUE

- **Reunión en el Ministerio de Transportes sobre la propuesta para digitalizar el pago de impuestos en la Administración Pública** — Guinea Ecuatorial Press, 28 September 2026

  An Equatorial Guinean e-wallet provider presented itself to the transport ministry as a channel for collecting state revenue, citing a 2025 Presidency order that bans cash payment of any tax or fee in the administration. The company is seeking a favourable technical review.

Eswatini

UNAYO MOBILE BANKING PLATFORM

- **Standard Bank eyes integrated banking as Unayo phased out** — Eswatini Observer, 9 September 2026

  Standard Bank Eswatini will close its Unayo wallet platform on 31 December 2026, the Eswatini Observer reported on 9 September 2026. Unayo has more than 200,000 registered retail customers and about 5,000 business clients, of whom about 30% transact regularly; the bank says the Eswatini Payment Switch now provides the real-time transfers between banks and wallets that Unayo was built to offer.

- **STANDARD BANK REVIVES INSTANT MONEY AS UNAYO EXITS** — Eswatini Positive News, 4 October 2026

Standard Bank Eswatini has told customers by SMS that its Instant Money service will return as it prepares to close the Unayo digital platform on 31 December 2026. No relaunch date, fees or limits had been announced as of 4 October. Unayo users were advised to withdraw stored funds before the closure.

ESWATINI PAYMENT SWITCH

- **Eswatini payment system enters new era** — Eswatini Observer, 21 September 2026

  The Central Bank of Eswatini says the fast-payments service of the Eswatini Payment Switch now links banks and mobile-money providers in real time at any hour, with QR-code payments to merchants being built next. Speaking at Tourism Nkwe 2026 in Mbabane, a deputy director said open banking and a domestic card switch will follow. Links to other countries come at a later stage.

- **DELTAPAY BRINGS INSTANT PAYMENTS CLOSER TO HOME** — Eswatini Positive News, 12 October 2026

  DeltaPay has gone live on the Eswatini Payment Switch, the Central Bank of Eswatini's national switch, letting its wallet users send money within seconds at any time, including weekends, to customers of participating banks and wallets. No go-live date or fees are given.

PROVIDENT FUND DIGITISATION

- **ENPF cuts claims processing from days to three hours** — Times of Eswatini, 7 October 2026

  The Eswatini National Provident Fund launched Express Claims on 6 October 2026, promising payment within three hours for claims of up to E5,000 from members who have completed identity checks, as a pilot. It also launched a debit-card payment gateway for contributions on its portal. Government reporting had put average claim processing at about 1.6 days.

POST OFFICES AS GOVERNMENT PAYMENT POINTS

- **GOVT TO USE POST OFFICES AS COMMUNITY DIGITAL CENTRES – PS PRINCE MASHISHIMBA** — Eswatini Positive News, 9 October 2026

  Eswatini's ICT principal secretary, Prince Mashishimba Andreas Dlamini, said on 9 October 2026, World Post Day, that the government plans to use post offices as community digital centres for public services. Eswatini Post would be brought into e-government work, supporting citizen authentication, document verification and digital payments in rural and underserved areas. No timetable or cost is given.

Ethiopia

M-PESA ETHIOPIA CARDLESS ATM WITHDRAWALS

- **M-PESA Ethiopia Expands Cardless ATM Withdrawals Through Awash Bank Partnership** — Tech Africa News, 8 September 2026

  M-PESA Ethiopia has extended cardless ATM withdrawals to Awash Bank's machines, letting wallet holders draw cash without a bank card by authorising the withdrawal in the app. The service has been live with Bank of Abyssinia since August; the date it started with Awash Bank is not stated.

MOBILE MONEY WALLETS OPENED AGAINST ADULTS HOLDING AN ACCOUNT

- **Mobile Money in Ethiopia - A Diagnostic Report** — DFS Ethiopia Hub (Team Shega), 9 September 2026

  A diagnostic report by Ethiopia's Team Shega, published on 9 September 2026, finds that more than 135 million mobile wallets have been opened, yet fewer than one adult in ten holds a mobile money account and 0.4% rely on one alone. Drawing on Global Findex 2025, UNCDF and central bank data, it finds most inclusion gains were bank-led and makes eight recommendations.

ETHIOPAY NATIONAL INSTANT PAYMENT SYSTEM

- **EthSwitch takes Ethiopia's digital payments push to global fintech stage** — TechReviewAfrica, 10 September 2026

  Ethiopia's national payment switch EthSwitch presented its interoperable payments work at the Global Fintech Fest in Mumbai on 8–11 September 2026, where its chief portfolio officer Abeneazer Lakew joined a digital public infrastructure panel. EthSwitch said in May that its EthioPay instant-payment service handled over one million transactions worth 5.1 billion birr in a single day.

MANDATORY FAYDA INTEGRATION WITH BANK ACCOUNTS

- **CBE Gives Customers Until November 9 to Link Bank Accounts with Fayda ID** — Birr Metrics, 16 September 2026

  The Commercial Bank of Ethiopia has given customers outside Addis Ababa, Dire Dawa, Harari and 24 other cities until 9 November 2026 to link their accounts to the Fayda national digital ID, under a National Bank of Ethiopia directive. Unlinked accounts in areas already covered face debit restrictions blocking withdrawals and transfers. Linking can be done at branches or online.

PAN-AFRICAN PAYMENT AND SETTLEMENT SYSTEM MEMBERSHIP

- **Ethiopia Joins PAPSS in Major Step Towards Pan-African Payments** — FSX Business, 30 September 2026

  Ethiopia has joined the Pan-African Payment and Settlement System as its 31st member country, having signed its bylaws about a month earlier after delays over concern that financial data would be exposed to other members. Four Ethiopian banks await no-objection letters from the National Bank of Ethiopia, and PAPSS aims to connect half the country's banks by March 2027.

- **Mobile money wallets set to link with PAPSS, opening access to African markets** — Capital Newspaper, 4 October 2026

  Ethiopia's non-bank mobile-money operators and payment-service providers are preparing to connect to the Pan-African Payment and Settlement System. Each needs a letter of no objection from the National Bank of Ethiopia first, and operators are weighing a direct connection against routing through EthSwitch or partner banks.

- **Ethiopia Joins PAPSS Network as National Bank of Ethiopia and PAPSS Announce the 2nd Edition of COWRY in Addis Ababa** — African Export-Import Bank (Afreximbank), 15 October 2026

  Ethiopia has joined the Pan-African Payment and Settlement System, the National Bank of Ethiopia and PAPSS announced in Addis Ababa on 15 October 2026, letting Ethiopian financial institutions make cross-border payments through the network. Addis Ababa will also host the PAPSS COWRY payments conference on 26-27 November.

- **Ethiopia modernises cross-border payments via PAPSS** — ITWeb Africa, 16 October 2026

  Ethiopia has joined the Pan-African Payment and Settlement System, letting its financial institutions make instant cross-border payments in local currencies with counterparts elsewhere in Africa. The National Bank of Ethiopia reports that digital transaction volumes grew by 146% a year from 2020 to 2025, and the country received $8.2 billion in remittances in 2025/26.

UNIFIED GOVERNMENT PAYMENT PLATFORM

- **EthSwitch Unveils Unified Government Payment Platform** — Tech Africa News, 1 October 2026

Ethiopia's national payment switch presented a unified government payment platform at the Ethiopia Finance Forum. It would give government bill payments one interoperable route across mobile apps, ATMs, USSD, branches and agents.

VALUE OF DIGITAL FINANCIAL TRANSACTIONS

- **Digital Finance Surge Marks Turning Point for Ethiopian Banking Sector: NBE** — Ethiopian News Agency, 1 October 2026

  Ethiopia recorded digital financial transactions worth 33 trillion birr in the 2025/26 fiscal year, Gemechis Dugasa, regulation and licensing director at the National Bank of Ethiopia, told the Ethiopia Finance Forum on 30 September 2026. He linked the growth to mobile money and digital banking and called for stronger cybersecurity, data protection and governance.

VISA AND ETTA CONTACTLESS ACCEPTANCE DEVICE ROLLOUT

- **Ethiopia’s commerce goes contactless with new Visa and ETTA infrastructure agreement** — Capital Newspaper (Ethiopia), 7 October 2026

  ETTA Solutions and Visa signed a framework agreement to roll out 148,000 contactless payment devices to Ethiopian merchants, jointly financed by both companies. The devices connect to ETTA's ZooryaPay platform, licensed by the National Bank of Ethiopia, and are certified by the tax authority as cash registers and e-receipt terminals. Merchant transaction data feed credit profiles built by Optasia. No sum is stated.

INTERNATIONAL PAYMENT CARD ISSUANCE BY DOMESTIC BANKS

- **Banks Race to Launch International Payment Cards as Forex Reforms Open New Market** — Birr Metrics, 9 October 2026

  Ethiopia's Awash Bank, with Mastercard, and Oromia Bank, with Visa, launched eight internationally accepted payment cards between them on 8 October 2026. The launches follow the National Bank of Ethiopia's February 2026 rule change allowing banks to issue such cards to foreign-currency account holders. Awash said it processed over US$60 million in card foreign exchange last fiscal year.

Gabon

ORDONNANCE 0002/PR/2026 ON DIGITAL PAYMENTS

- **Communiqué final du Conseil des Ministres du 08 octobre 2026** — Journal du Gabon (government communiqué), 8 October 2026

  Gabon's Council of Ministers adopted a bill on 8 October 2026 ratifying and amending the ordinance of 26 February 2026 on digital payments. The text aligns the national framework with CEMAC payment rules, regulates payment-solution providers, promotes interoperability with regional and international systems and provides for the gradual dematerialisation of public and private payments.

MADIGIPAIE

- **Gabon updates digital payment laws to support regional interoperability** — Biometric Update, 12 October 2026

  An account of Gabon's bill ratifying its digital payments ordinance ties it to the regional central bank's interoperability rules. It puts the national merchant QR scheme at more than 3,273 merchants and 1,382 GIMAC QR codes as of July.

Ghana

ACTIVE MOBILE MONEY USERS, DOMINANT OPERATOR

- **MTN pushes mobile money beyond payments** — ITWeb Africa, 3 September 2026

  The chief executive of MTN Mobile Money Ghana said that fewer than 0.3% of its users are actively investing and only a small proportion save regularly, against more than 26 million transactions a day, and rejected the description of Ghana as a mature market.

VIRTUAL ASSET SERVICE PROVIDER REGULATORY SANDBOX

- **Yellow Card joins Ghana's second virtual asset regulatory sandbox** — MyJoyOnline, 4 September 2026

  Stablecoin firm Yellow Card was admitted on 4 September 2026 to the second cohort of Ghana's regulatory sandbox for virtual asset service providers, one of 10 participants. The sandbox is run by the Securities and Exchange Commission with the Bank of Ghana under the Virtual Asset Service Providers Act passed in December 2025; Yellow Card will test stablecoin payments, fiat settlement and digital wallets.

DIGITAL CREDIT SERVICE PROVIDER REGIME

- **Bank of Ghana Notice No. BG/GOV/SEC/29 — Unlicensed Digital Credit Services Providers** — Bank of Ghana, 8 September 2026

  The Bank of Ghana named 20 more unlicensed mobile loan apps on 8 September 2026, including CreditGo, Cash Cedi, Sika Credit and Zoom Advance, five weeks after listing a different 20 in August. It said they breach its September 2025 directive on digital credit providers and warned banks and payment service providers not to process their transactions.

- **BoG names 20 unlicensed digital loan providers** — Ghana News Agency, 9 September 2026

  The Bank of Ghana published a list of 20 mobile loan apps operating without a licence on 9 September 2026, among them Cash Cedi, CreditGo, Quick Cedi and Zoom Advance. It said they breach customer data privacy and consumer protection rules under its September 2025 directive on digital credit providers. Banks and payment service providers were told not to process transactions for them.

- **Bank of Ghana Notice No. BG/GOV/SEC/2026/36: Unlicensed Digital Credit Services Providers** — Bank of Ghana, 6 October 2026

  The Bank of Ghana named 20 mobile loan apps, including Agile Loan, KudiNow, SikaNow and Susu Loan, operating without its licence in a notice dated 6 October 2026. It said they breach its September 2025 directive on digital credit providers and customers' data privacy, and warned banks and payment service providers not to process their transactions.

- **BoG cautions public against 20 unlicensed mobile loan apps** — MyJoyOnline, 8 October 2026

  The Bank of Ghana warned the public against 20 mobile loan apps operating without its licence, including Agile Loan, KudiNow, SikaNow and Zatuloan, saying they breach the Directive for Digital Credit Service Providers. It cited risks to customer data privacy and consumer protection and said it is working with state agencies on enforcement.

DLOCAL GHANA ENHANCED PAYMENT SERVICE PROVIDER LICENCE

- **dLocal Ghana secures enhanced payments licence to deepen local operations** — TechCabal, 9 September 2026

dLocal Ghana, the subsidiary of the Uruguayan payments company, has secured an Enhanced Payment Service Provider licence from the Bank of Ghana, letting it provide local collections, merchant acquiring, mobile-money acceptance and payouts in its own name where it had previously routed Ghana flows through its global platform and regulated third-party partners. It will roll the services out on operational readiness rather than at once. Paystack and Flutterwave hold comparable licences and Fincra was licensed in the enhanced category in May 2026; Bank of Ghana data put mobile money at GH¢4.54 trillion in 2025, up 50.8 per cent on 2024.

VISA ACCEPT VIRTUAL POINT OF SALE AT ACCESS BANK GHANA

- **Access Bank, Visa launch digital payment tool 'Visa Accept' to bring small merchants into formal economy** — Modern Ghana, 18 September 2026

  Access Bank Ghana and Visa launched Visa Accept in Accra on 18 September 2026, a virtual point-of-sale tool in the bank's mobile app that lets small merchants take card taps, QR codes or payment links on a smartphone, with funds credited instantly. The bank's retail director Eugene Ocansey said the transaction records could help informal businesses qualify for credit.

- **Access Bank, Visa Launch First CEMEA Visa Accept Market in Ghana** — Current Issues Online, 18 September 2026

  Access Bank Ghana and Visa launched Visa Accept on 18 September 2026, a feature in the bank's mobile app that lets small merchants take contactless card payments on their own smartphones without a point-of-sale terminal. Ghana is the first market for the service in Visa's Central and Eastern Europe, Middle East and Africa region; the bank plans a door-to-door merchant campaign. No fees are given.

BANK-BACKED VIRTUAL ACCOUNTS FOR VIRTUAL-ASSET BUSINESSES

- **Chipper Cash launches bank-backed virtual accounts with UMB** — Graphic Online, 23 September 2026

  Fintech firm Chipper Cash began opening bank-backed virtual accounts for customers in Ghana through an API link with Universal Merchant Bank, reported on 23 September 2026. The bank had received Bank of Ghana and Securities and Exchange Commission approval to offer virtual accounts to businesses in the virtual asset sector; the approval date is not stated.

Guinea

ONLINE PAYMENT FOR PORT CLEARANCE AT CONAKRY TERMINAL

- **Conakry Terminal : de nouveaux paiements en ligne pour accélérer la digitalisation des services** — Mediaguinee, 18 September 2026

  Conakry Terminal, a subsidiary of Africa Global Logistics in Guinea, launched online payment for port services on 18 September 2026 with the fintechs TouchPoint and Akiba, letting clients invoice, pay and obtain delivery orders without visiting a counter. Director-general Édouard Léno said more than 300 clients had made over 10,000 transactions worth more than 60 billion Guinean francs, and set a goal of raising the digital share of payments from 20% to 50%.

NATIONAL PAYMENT SWITCH

- **Appel à manifestation d'intérêt pour le recrutement d'un cabinet pour la conception et la mise en œuvre d'un scheme national de paiement (SNP) en République de Guinée** — WARDIP-Guinée (MCENI), via Le Travail 224, 1 October 2026

Guinea's WARDIP project, under the digital economy ministry, invited expressions of interest on 1 October 2026, due by 23 October, from firms to design and implement a national payment scheme. The nine-month assignment supports the national switch GuiM and the central bank, BCRG, on governance, rules, security and a business model through to a pilot. It is paid from a US$60 million IDA financing.

Kenya

KENYAN BANK PARTICIPATION IN PAPSS

- **ABC Bank goes live on intra-African pay system** — Business Today Kenya, 7 September 2026 AFRICA

  Kenya's African Banking Corporation (ABC Bank) has gone live on the Pan-African Payment and Settlement System, letting customers send and receive payments across 28 African countries. Customers can pay accounts at more than 190 participating banks, sending either in Kenyan shillings or in the recipient's currency.

- **PAPSS goes live at I&M Bank Kenya to expand cross-border payments** — TechReviewAfrica, 20 September 2026 AFRICA

  The Pan-African Payment and Settlement System went live for customers of I&M Bank Kenya, the second Kenyan bank on the network. Customers can send to participating African markets in Kenyan shillings through the bank's branches rather than converting into an international currency; no volume, fee or corridor detail was published.

ACCESS TO CROSS-BORDER CONSUMER PAYMENT PLATFORMS

- **The platforms that help Kenyans get paid are changing the rules** — TechCabal, 8 September 2026

  The cross-border routes Kenyans use to be paid narrowed one by one over the past year: an international payments provider restricted accounts, a dollar-banking service closed, a remittance wallet paused and a streaming platform ended creator monetisation.

MERCHANT PAYMENT-INTEGRATION TOOL

- **Kenya : Kopo Kopo lance une nouvelle solution pour simplifier les paiements** — wearetech.africa, 10 September 2026

  A Kenyan technology company has launched an updated payment-integration tool letting businesses embed settlement options directly in their own software, merchant sites and mobile applications. It says more than 40,000 merchants can now automate refunds, send grouped payments and process transactions faster.

MOBILE MONEY SUBSCRIPTIONS AND AGENTS

- **Kenya Mobile Money Accounts Hit 54 Million Even as More Than 34,000 Agents Exit the Market** — Dawan Africa, 18 September 2026

  Kenya's regulator put mobile money subscriptions at 54,005,800 at the end of June 2026, up 1.2 per cent in the quarter and 13.2 per cent on the year, while more than 34,000 registered agents left the market in the same three months. Subscriptions count accounts, not people.

KCB GROUP ACQUISITION OF A STAKE IN PESAPAL

- **Tanzania regulator reveals KCB's 22.23% stake in payments firm Pesapal** — TechCabal, 22 September 2026 TANZANIA

Tanzania's Fair Competition Commission put KCB Group's stake in Kenyan payments firm Pesapal at 22.23%, the first public figure for a deal KCB announced in 2025 without terms. The stake gives KCB indirect control of Pesapal Tanzania and is under the commission's review; its value is undisclosed.

KENSWITCH DOMESTIC CARD SCHEME

- **Kenswitch enters Kenya's card market with domestic card scheme** — TechCabal, 24 September 2026

  Kenswitch, Kenya's largest independent payments switch, launched a domestic card scheme on 22 September that lets banks and other institutions issue physical and virtual cards on its network of more than 2,200 ATMs, 50,000 point-of-sale terminals and 80,000 agent outlets. It named no issuers, launch dates or pricing against Visa and Mastercard.

REGISTERED MOBILE-MONEY ACCOUNTS AND AGENTS

- **The Next Wave: Kenya’s payments revolution cannot end with mobile money** — TechCabal, 27 September 2026

  A commentary argues that Kenya's success with mobile money has left the rest of its payments system neglected, citing central bank figures of 94.35 million registered accounts and KES 728.7 billion moved in July 2026. It calls for attention to bank rails, cards and cross-border payments beyond the dominant wallet.

DIGITAL CREDIT PROVIDER LICENSING

- **Kenya licenses 29 new digital lenders** — ITWeb Africa, 30 September 2026

  Trade-press report of the Central Bank of Kenya's licensing of 29 more digital lenders, summarised under the bank's own press release.

- **Press Release: Licensing of Digital Credit Providers** — Central Bank of Kenya, 30 September 2026

  The Central Bank of Kenya licensed 29 more digital credit providers, bringing the total to 281, from more than 900 applications since March 2022. Licensed lenders had made 9,596,509 loans worth Ksh165.1 billion by August 2026.

M-PESA TAP-TO-PAY AND QR ON PESAPAL TERMINALS

- **Safaricom taps Pesapal’s 30,000 POS terminals to take M-PESA contactless** — TechCabal, 1 October 2026

  Safaricom and Pesapal put M-PESA tap-to-pay and QR payment on Pesapal's 30,000 point-of-sale terminals in Kenya, with no extra fee. Safaricom says scan-to-pay is live at more than 60,000 merchant outlets and targets 500,000 within a year.

EMMA WALLET (FINSERVE AFRICA)

- **The strategy behind Equity Bank’s new digital wallet** — TechCabal, 6 October 2026

  Equity Bank's fintech arm, Finserve Africa, has launched a wallet called EMMA, reached by Android application, short code or the Equitel SIM toolkit and opened with an identity document and a facial check. Users can send money to M-PESA merchants, Airtel Money and bank accounts; the analysis reads it as the bank's bid to keep everyday payments, and the data behind them, on its own platform.

PESALINK ID ACCOUNT ALIAS

- **PesaLink’s New ID Makes Bank Transfers Easier. The Bigger Question Is Who Owns the Rail.** — Fintech Association of Kenya (LinkedIn), 8 October 2026

Kenya's bank-owned instant payment switch says a portable identifier is ready, so a sender need not know the recipient's bank, and institutions must now map customers to it. A fintech association asks who will own the rail as the alias takes hold.

MOOVNPAY WALLET AGREEMENT WITH MASTERCARD

- **Mastercard and Moovn sign five-year deal to expand digital payments across East Africa** — TechAfrica News, 19 October 2026 TANZANIA

  Mastercard and Moovn Technologies signed a five-year agreement, announced on 19 October 2026, to add Mastercard prepaid cards, tokenisation, online acceptance, Pay Local and cross-border transfers to the MoovnPay wallet. Pay Local is to expand across Kenya and Tanzania, and the Shooga prepaid Mastercard portfolio is to launch next.

Lesotho

VOUCHER-FREE ELECTRONIC AIRTIME

- **Vodacom launches voucher-free airtime service** — Lesotho Times, 4 September 2026

  Vodacom Lesotho launched Dynamic Airtime in the week of 4 September 2026, letting customers buy airtime electronically in any amount from M1.50 instead of using fixed-value physical vouchers. Vendors enter the customer's number and amount and confirm the name registered to the SIM before the airtime is credited.

Liberia

NATIONAL ELECTRONIC PAYMENT SWITCH

- **Finance Minister Highlights Economic Growth, Revenue Mobilization, Infrastructure, Digital Payments and Diaspora Capital at Washington Conference** — Cape 96.5 FM/TV, 26 September 2026

  Liberia's Finance Minister Augustine Kpehe Ngafuan told a diaspora conference in Washington that the Inclusive Instant Payment System, launched by the Central Bank of Liberia in December 2025, processed more than 1.5 million transactions worth over L$1.4 billion and US$9 million in its first three months. It first linked the Lonestar MTN and Orange mobile-money platforms. A national electronic payment switch is the longer-term aim.

- **Bet on Liberia** — The New Dawn Liberia, 28 September 2026

  Liberia's finance minister told the diaspora conference near Washington that the national electronic payment switch is targeted for March 2027, alongside the central bank's inclusive instant payment system.

DIGIGOV LIBERIA GOVERNMENT PAYMENTS (P2G AND G2P) DIGITISATION PROJECT

- **Multinational - Government Payments (P2G & G2P) Digitization in Mano River Union - Liberia - Project Completion Report** — African Development Bank Group, 27 September 2026

  The African Development Bank published on 27 September 2026 the completion report for DIGIGOV Liberia, part of its project to digitise government payments in the Mano River Union. The project aimed to set up an e-payment system hosted by the Liberia Revenue Authority for customs tax collection, build local digital finance capacity and run consumer-protection work. The summary page gives no results or figures.

PAY NA-NA INCLUSIVE INSTANT PAYMENT SYSTEM

- **Liberia's Instant Payment System Crosses 5.3M Transactions** — Liberian Observer, 1 October 2026

> Liberia's instant payment system has processed more than 5.3 million transactions between the two mobile money operators since its December 2025 launch, the central bank governor said. About 4.2 million were in Liberian dollars and 1.1 million in US dollars.

Libya

GROSS VALUE OF ELECTRONIC PAYMENT OPERATIONS

- **عيسى يناقش مع المصارف التجارية توفير السيولة والنقد الأجنبي** — Libyan News Agency (LANA), 3 September 2026

  Central Bank of Libya governor Naji Issa met commercial banks and the payments company Moamalat in Tripoli on 3 September 2026 on cash liquidity, foreign-currency supply and the electronic payment system. The central bank put the gross value of electronic payments across all systems from 1 January to 31 August 2026 at about 764.9 billion Libyan dinars.

- **Electronic transactions reached 865 billion Libyan dinars by end of September 2026: CBL** — Libya Herald, 5 October 2026

  Libya's central bank said electronic transactions reached about 865 billion dinars by the end of September 2026. The figure came from a meeting between the governor, commercial bank heads and the state payments company on cash liquidity, wider electronic payment and cyber-risk readiness.

ZERO CASH CASHLESS INITIATIVE

- **«منتدى تطوير القطاع المصرفي يعلن التوقف عن متابعة تنفيذ مبادرة «صفر نقد** — Alwasat (Bawabat Al-Wasat), 7 September 2026

  Libya’s banking sector development forum said it has stopped pursuing its cashless initiative in the form submitted to the central bank, because the executive framework it needed was never issued.

DIRECT PAYMENT CORRIDOR TO CHINA

- **Libya's North Africa Bank to launch direct payment service to China using Alipay** — Libya Herald, 8 September 2026

  A privately owned Libyan bank said it will launch a direct mobile payment service to China, capped at US$5,000 a transaction and US$50,000 a year.

CENTRAL BANK CIRCULAR 9/2026 ON MOBILE PAYMENT AND ELECTRONIC WALLETS

- **مصرف ليبيا المركزي يضع ضوابط جديدة للمحافظ الإلكترونية ويرفع سقف التحويل اليومي إلى مليوني دينار للشركات - Bankawy** — Bankawy - 14 سهلنا عليك المشوار, أختار .. قارن .. أفهم September 2026

  The Central Bank of Libya issued Circular 9/2026 on mobile payments and e-wallets, reported on 14 September 2026. It lets licensed payment companies issue wallets to legally resident foreigners with a valid passport or residence document. Daily limits for Libyan citizens are 100,000 dinars person to person, 500,000 person to company and 2 million company to company; foreigners' limits are lower.

RATIBAK LAHZI REAL-TIME PAYROLL

- **The Central Bank of Libya announces the commencement of September salary payments through the "Your Salary Instantly" system** — Central Bank of Libya, 28 September 2026

  The Central Bank of Libya began paying September 2026 public-sector salaries through its "Your Salary Instantly" system on 28 September. About 1.75 million of 2.2 million public employees are registered, a 79% participation rate. The bank is working with the Ministry of Finance to automate complaints about unpaid salaries.

Madagascar

DEVELOPMENT BANK AND TELECOMS GROUP DIGITAL FINANCE PROGRAMME FOR WOMEN-LED BUSINESSES

- **African Development Bank and AXIAN Launch Digital Finance Programme to Support 34,000 Women-led Businesses in Africa** — African Development Bank Group (distributed by APO Group), 2 September 2026
  TANZANIA · SENEGAL · TOGO · COMOROS · SUB-SAHARAN AFRICA

  The African Development Bank and AXIAN Group launched a programme on 2 September 2026 to offer digital loans and financial services through AXIAN's Mixx and MVola mobile money platforms to 34,000 women-led small businesses in Madagascar, Tanzania and Senegal. A second component will train 25,000 women in those countries plus Togo and the Comoros. No committed amount is stated.

- **AfDB, AXIAN Take Digital Finance to 34,000 Women-led Businesses in Africa** — Ecofin Agency, 4 September 2026 TANZANIA · SENEGAL · TOGO · COMOROS

  The African Development Bank and AXIAN launched a programme to reach 34,000 women-led small businesses in Madagascar, Tanzania and Senegal with loans and financial services through AXIAN's Mixx and MVola mobile-money platforms, with training for 25,000 women in five countries. It follows a US$160m AfDB loan to AXIAN Telecom approved in January 2025, alongside a US$2.5m grant.

MOBILE MONEY COMPLAINTS TASK FORCE

- **Une Task Force sera mise en place pour améliorer le traitement des réclamations liées au Mobile Money** — 2424.mg, 15 September 2026

  The finance ministry announced a task force on mobile money complaints, bringing the banking supervision commission and the communications regulator together to speed up resolution. Users report lost money, failed transactions and long waits.

GASY MONEY MOBILE-BANKING APP (BGFIBANK)

- **Gasy Money: BGFIBank Madagascar réinvente le mobile banking** — Newsmada, 21 September 2026

  BGFIBank Madagascar launched Gasy Money, a mobile banking app open to people without an account at the bank, including those with no bank account at all, on any mobile network. The launch date was not given. It handles deposits and withdrawals through agents, branches and ATMs, merchant and bill payments, top-ups of prepaid Visa cards, and transfers to bank accounts and Airtel Money.

- **Mobile banking : Gasy Money entre dans la course de la finance digitale** — Midi Madagasikara, 22 September 2026

  BGFIBank Madagasikara presented its Gasy Money mobile banking app at the Carlton Anosy hotel in Antananarivo, open to the bank's customers, users of other banks and people without bank accounts. The app currently allows national money transfers through partnerships with mobile operators, and manages the bank's Karatro prepaid card for international use. No fees or user targets are given.

MVOLA MOBILE MONEY PLATFORM

- **INCLUSION FINANCIÈRE - La digitalisation et les services financiers à démocratiser** — L'Express de Madagascar, 3 October 2026

  Madagascar's Mvola has made merchant payments free for customers, with the merchant bearing the fee. The mobile money operator reports close to 4 million users, more than 60,000 cashpoints and more than 50,000 merchants accepting payment.

ANTANANARIVO MARKET FEE DIGITALISATION

- **Madagascar: Commune Urbaine d'Antananarivo - Coup d'envoi de la digitalisation des marchés** — Midi Madagasikara (allAfrica), 8 October 2026

  Antananarivo's urban commune began digitalising its markets: traders are registered on tablet and issued chip and QR cards debited by collectors' payment terminals in place of paper tickets. Markets bring the commune MGA 7 to 9 billion a year.

DEVELOPMENT FUND CASH-TRANSFER PAYMENTS BY MOBILE MONEY AND QR CODE

- **La sélection des prestataires de services de transfert monétaires par mobile money** — Fonds d'Intervention pour le Développement (FID), 9 October 2026

  Madagascar's development intervention fund FID is tendering for mobile-money providers to pay social cash transfers, in seven lots, under World Bank procurement rules. Bids close on 3 November 2026.

Malawi

ELECTRONIC PAYMENT OF TRAFFIC FINES

- **Malawi police digitises traffic fines** — ITWeb Africa, 4 September 2026

  The Malawi Police Service introduced electronic payment of traffic fines, going live at headquarters in Lilongwe and across the country's six police regions from the week of 4 September, with payment through named commercial banks and both mobile money services. The ICT industry association welcomed it as fraud-reducing but urged the service to secure the system and to train staff and inform the public.

UNCONDITIONAL CASH TRANSFERS PAID BY MOBILE MONEY

- **Canva's $150m Boost Expands GiveDirectly's Lifeline to the Poorest in Malawi** — ednews.africa, 15 September 2026

  A cash-transfer organisation working in Malawi since 2019 expanded after a US$150m donation, paying unconditional lump sums of about US$550 directly to the poorest adults by mobile money.

Mauritania

MOBILE BANKING AND PAYMENTS SERVICE

- **بنكيلي.. التطبيق الذي صنع الدفع الرقمي في موريتانيا** — Le Quotidien de Nouakchott, 8 September 2026

  A commentary in Le Quotidien de Nouakchott defends Bankily, the mobile banking app Banque Populaire de Mauritanie launched in 2020, after complaints about a faulty update that was temporarily rolled back. Citing the central bank's 2025 annual report, it says Bankily handles about 1.1 million transactions a day, nearly 80% of bank-wallet transactions by number and 73.5% by value.

NATIONAL INSTANT PAYMENT SYSTEM FOR FINANCIAL-SERVICES INTEROPERABILITY

- **Implementation of an instant payment system in Mauritania enabling the interoperability of financial services** — Mauritania Tenders, 16 September 2026

  Mauritania sought providers for an instant payment system to make financial services interoperable, under the World Bank-financed regional digital integration programme. The call closed on 3 June 2025.

TRADE FACILITATION COMMITMENT ON ELECTRONIC PAYMENT OF DUTIES

- **Mauritanie — 7.2 Paiement par voie électronique (Base de données de l'Accord sur la facilitation des échanges)** — World Trade Organization, 16 September 2026

Mauritania's commitment under the WTO trade facilitation agreement to allow electronic payment of border duties was due by 31 December 2024; it has asked for 31 December 2027, saying it still needs a partner to help, and the request is not yet approved. The work includes linking the customs system, the Treasury and banks.

CENTRAL BANK DIGITAL CURRENCY (MNBC) PROOF OF CONCEPT

- **BCM : réforme bancaire, fintech et monnaie numérique au cœur de la modernisation** — TRUST Magazine, 20 September 2026

  The Central Bank of Mauritania's newsletter for August 2026 reports a week of sandbox tests for its central bank digital currency proof of concept. It also reports a data platform holding over 78 million records since January 2024, two GIZ-backed fintech hackathons set for 19–22 October 2026, and a draft monetary and financial code due by mid-2027.

Mauritius

COMESA REGIONAL PAYMENT AND SETTLEMENT SYSTEM (REPSS) SETTLEMENT BANK

- **Cross-border payments as a necessity for Africa's resilience and economic transformation** — Bank for International Settlements (central bankers' speeches); speech by the Bank of Mauritius, 13 October 2026

  SUB-SAHARAN AFRICA

  The Governor of the Bank of Mauritius, Priscilla Muthoora Thakoor, told a Financial Stability Board workshop in Port Louis on 15 July 2026 that sub-Saharan Africa will miss the G20's 2027 targets for cross-border payments. She described REPSS, SADC-RTGS, TCIB and PAPSS as complementary regional systems and warned that stablecoins could undermine monetary sovereignty. The speech was posted on 13 October.

Morocco

MEMORANDUM WITH THE UAE CENTRAL BANK ON INTERLINKING PAYMENT SYSTEMS

- **CBUAE, Bank Al-Maghrib sign two MoUs to strengthen supervisory cooperation, Islamic finance** — Eye of Riyadh, 4 October 2026

  Bank Al-Maghrib and the Central Bank of the UAE signed two memoranda in Abu Dhabi. One covers supervisory information exchange and Islamic finance; the other is to explore linking the two countries' instant payment platforms, card switches and financial messaging systems, and to exchange expertise on central bank digital currencies.

RETAIL CENTRAL BANK DIGITAL CURRENCY (RESEARCH AND PROOF OF CONCEPT)

- **A DSGE Model for a Small Open Economy with a CBDC Option (Bank Al-Maghrib Working Paper)** — Bank Al-Maghrib, 7 October 2026

  A Bank Al-Maghrib working paper dated 7 October 2026, by Michael Kumhof, Mohammed Mikou and Yassine Slaoui, builds an economic model calibrated on Morocco with banked and unbanked households, which can be run with or without a retail central bank digital currency. Under its baseline assumptions, introducing the currency brings modest output gains and modestly better resilience to financial shocks.

- **Monnaie Digitale de Banque Centrale : Enjeux et enseignements pour le Maroc (Document de travail)** — Bank Al-Maghrib, 7 October 2026

A Bank Al-Maghrib working paper on central bank digital currency says a proof of concept built with the IMF and World Bank confirmed that a retail CBDC is technically feasible in Morocco. It reports a cross-border CBDC experiment under way with the Central Bank of Egypt and treats any issuance as long-term and gradual. The views are the authors', not the bank's.

- بنك المغرب يصدر وثيقتي عمل حول العملة الرقمية للبنك المركزي — Assabah, 9 October 2026

  Morocco's central bank published two research working papers on a central bank digital currency, one on the stakes and lessons for Morocco and one a modelling exercise. It presents them as its researchers' work, shared for debate.

CASH IN CIRCULATION AND CARD USE

- زحف "الكاش" يمتحن نجاعة خطط "بنك المغرب" لتوسيع الأداء الرقمي — Hespress, 13 October 2026

  Cash in circulation in Morocco reached 550.3 billion dirhams at the end of August 2026, up 12.1% since the end of 2025, according to Bank Al-Maghrib data. Cash withdrawals made up 85% of the value of card transactions in 2025, even as bank cards rose 7.7% to 23.5 million. The central bank is expanding merchant acceptance, a unified QR payment platform and digital public payments.

Mozambique

MERCHANT MOBILE-MONEY SETTLEMENT INTO BANK ACCOUNTS

- **FACIM 2026: Absa e M-Pesa Reforcam Parceria Para Facilitar Pagamentos Digitais e Gestao Financeira Dos Negocios** — Diario Economico, 2 September 2026

  Absa Bank Mozambique and M-Pesa signed a memorandum of understanding at the FACIM 2026 trade fair in Maputo, reported on 2 September 2026. It links M-Pesa's Paga Fácil merchant service to Absa accounts so merchants can move receipts into the bank at no cost, usually within minutes. No value is given.

SALARY-ADVANCE CREDIT FOR CIVIL SERVANTS OVER MOBILE MONEY

- **M-Pesa, Máximo Microbanco and CEDSIF open formal credit access to 380,000 Mozambican civil servants** — TechReviewAfrica, 4 September 2026

  M-Pesa, Máximo Microbanco and Mozambique's public finance information systems centre, CEDSIF, signed a memorandum at the 61st Maputo International Fair to offer salary-advance credit to more than 380,000 civil servants through the M-Pesa *150# menu. CEDSIF will verify eligibility and handle salary deductions for repayment. No value or loan limit is given.

ELECTRONIC MONEY ACCOUNTS PER 100 ADULTS

- **Moeda eletrónica tem quase quatro vezes mais contas do que a banca em Moçambique** — SAPO, 15 September 2026

  The same central bank figures show the accounts skewed male: 144.7 per 100 adult men against 118.5 per 100 adult women.

- **Mozambique: Number of electronic money accounts now almost four times the number of traditional bank accounts** — Club of Mozambique, 15 September 2026

  Electronic money accounts reached 130.9 per 100 adults in the second quarter of 2026, against 33.8 per 100 for traditional bank accounts, on central bank figures covering three operators.

PARTICIPATION IN THE REGIONAL REAL-TIME GROSS SETTLEMENT SYSTEM

- **Mozambique to Join SADC Real-Time Payments System in Q1 2027** — 360 Mozambique, 1 October 2026

  Mozambique plans to join the SADC RTGS regional payment system, hosted by the South African Reserve Bank, in the first quarter of 2027, Banco de Moçambique governor Felisberto Navalha said after the Monetary Policy Committee meeting. Customers would settle South African invoices directly from metical accounts; the system already carries the rand and, since July, Angola's kwanza.

- **Metical poderá ser usado em pagamentos na SADC a partir de Janeiro de 2027** — Times de Todos, 7 October 2026 SOUTHERN AFRICA

  Mozambique's central bank governor said the metical could be used for payments between Southern African countries from January 2027 through the regional real-time settlement system, which is hosted at South Africa's central bank.

PAWAPAY PAYMENT SERVICE PROVIDER LICENCE

- **PawaPay becomes one of the first licensed PSPs in Mozambique** — Pan African Visions, 8 October 2026

  The Bank of Mozambique licensed payments aggregator PawaPay as a payment service provider through its local subsidiary, among the first such licences. It can now onboard merchants directly across the country's three mobile money operators.

Namibia

INSTANT PAYMENT SOLUTION

- **Explainer: What is WayaMe?** — The Namibian, 3 September 2026

  WayaMe is the public name for Namibia's new instant payment system, operated by Instant Payments Namibia under the Bank of Namibia. It routes payments between participating banks and e-money wallets, which customers reach through their existing apps or USSD. The system is expected over time to carry government grants and pensions. No launch date is given.

SOCIAL GRANT BENEFICIARIES LOCKED OUT OF THE PAYMENT SYSTEM

- **5 700 grant beneficiaries still locked out of payment system** — Namibian Sun, 10 September 2026

  More than 5,700 Namibian pensioners and other social-grant beneficiaries remain locked out of the government payment system after their grants were suspended during an identity verification exercise earlier in 2026, the gender equality and child welfare minister told the National Assembly. She said 15,785 were affected in all, of whom 10,066 had verified their identities, been reinstated and paid, and defended the exercise as ensuring public money reaches only legitimate beneficiaries while acknowledging it had delayed vulnerable people.

Niger

MOBILE-MONEY PAYMENT AT THE VEHICLE ONE-STOP SHOP

- **Guichet Unique Automobile: SONILOGA ouvre le paiement de ses prestations à Airtel Money** — ActuNiger, 2 October 2026

  The operator of Niger's vehicle one-stop shop began accepting Airtel Money for some of its services on 1 October, through an app or an offline USSD code. The transport ministry presented it as a way to trace public revenue.

Nigeria

FAIRMONEY REGISTERED USERS

- **La banque numérique FairMoney dépasse les 30 millions d'usagers au Nigeria** — wearetech.africa, 4 September 2026

  The digital bank FairMoney has passed 30 million registered users in Nigeria, reported on 4 September 2026. Its mobile app offers savings, transfers and credit to individuals and small businesses. No further figures are given.

CASH TRANSFERS THE STATE AUDITOR COULD NOT EVIDENCE AS DELIVERED

- **Tinubu's Invisible Beneficiaries of Cash Transfers** — ThisDay, 6 September 2026

  A ThisDay column by Weneso Orogun discusses Nigeria's Auditor-General's 2024 report, which found the National Cash Transfer Office paid N33.75 billion to 3,295,207 households in 35 states in 2023 without records reconciling recipients against the National Social Register. The report says office staff obstructed auditors' requests for the Remita statements.

- **Falana, SERAP Demand Probe into N33.75bn Cash Transfer** — The Punch, 7 September 2026

  The Auditor-General's 2024 report states that the government could not provide auditors with sufficient evidence that ₦33.75bn of cash transfers intended for more than 3.29 million vulnerable households reached genuine beneficiaries, the payment platform's statements not having been supplied. A rights lawyer has asked the financial crimes commission to investigate and a civil-society organisation puts over ₦78.8bn across social protection programmes as diverted, unaccounted for or irregularly spent.

DIASPORA REMITTANCE INFLOWS AND THEIR COST

- **How Remittance Startups Are Undercutting Western Union Across Africa** — TechTrends Africa, 6 September 2026 AFRICA

  Sending US$200 to sub-Saharan Africa cost an average of 8.46% in the third quarter of 2025, against a global average of 6.36%, according to World Bank figures cited by TechTrends Africa. Apps such as LemFi and Sendwave now run the London to Lagos corridor at about 2-3%, against around 7.8% in 2023.

VALUE OF ELECTRONIC PAYMENTS

- **Nigeria's Digital Economy Is Surging, But Its Fibre Backbone Is Under Threat** — HighStreet.ng, 13 September 2026

  The Central Bank of Nigeria's quarterly bulletin records N1.053 quadrillion in electronic payments in the first quarter of 2026, up 2.85% on a year earlier and the highest quarter since its series began in 2019. Point-of-sale volume fell 19.9%. Nigerian Communications Commission data show 5,934 fibre-optic cable cuts in the first half of 2026, about 65 a day.

NATIONAL DIGITAL INVOICING AND FINANCIAL OPTIMISATION STRATEGY

- **FG targets cheap loans with digital invoices** — The Sun (Nigeria), 18 September 2026

  Nigeria inaugurated the steering committee of a National Digital Invoicing and Financial Optimisation Strategy, meant to let businesses raise working capital against verified digital invoices. The trade minister framed it as moving e-invoicing beyond tax compliance into a national receivables-finance corridor; no rules or launch date are set.

REMITA CONSUMER SUPER APP

- **Remita moves beyond payments with new consumer super app** — The Condia, 23 September 2026

  Nigerian payments company Remita launched a consumer app at Nigeria Fintech Week in Lagos on 22 September 2026. It shows accounts across several banks, sends money to other African countries over PAPSS, and offers loans assessed using NIN and BVN checks. Managing director 'DeRemi Atanda put Remita's enterprise and government throughput above N100 trillion a year.

- **Nigeria : Remita lance une application pour gérer les comptes bancaires** — wearetech.africa, 25 September 2026

  Remita launched a mobile app at Nigeria Fintech Week on 23 September that brings several bank accounts into one interface. Users can make payments, invest and send money to other African countries.

MONIEPOINT AGENT POINT-OF-SALE NETWORK

- **What happens when a PoS terminal becomes an investment outlet?** — TechCabal, 25 September 2026

  Moniepoint is selling shares in the Dangote Petroleum Refinery's ₦2.15 trillion IPO through its agent point-of-sale terminals across all 774 local government areas. Buyers are identified by their Bank Verification Number and capped at ₦100,000 each, a test of the agent network as a channel for investment products.

HABARIPAY PAYMENT SWITCHING AND PROCESSING

- **Guaranty Trust Holding Company Plc - Audited Consolidated and Separate Financial Statements for the period ended 30 June 2026** — Guaranty Trust Holding Company Plc, 28 September 2026

  Guaranty Trust Holding Company's audited financial statements for the half-year to 30 June 2026, with an auditor's report dated 28 September, show its payments subsidiary HabariPay earning ₦7.81 billion profit after tax on ₦9.44 billion operating income. Group e-business income rose to ₦42.16 billion from ₦28.61 billion a year earlier, while technology and service expenses fell to ₦31.10 billion from ₦37.76 billion.

- **Guaranty Trust Holding Company Plc - June 2026 Half Year Investor Presentation** — Guaranty Trust Holding Company Plc, 2 October 2026

  Guaranty Trust Holding Company's investor presentation for the half-year to June 2026 reports transactions through its GTWorld mobile app of ₦26.70 trillion, up from ₦21.87 trillion a year earlier. Pay-with-Transfer value rose to ₦1.11 trillion from ₦70.05 billion. The deck carries no date of its own.

- **Five numbers showing how GTCO's payments strategy is taking shape** — TechCabal, 5 October 2026

  An analysis of Guaranty Trust Holding Company's half-year results shows its payments subsidiary HabariPay earning ₦7.81 billion in profit, close to double a year earlier, on ₦74.72 trillion switched. Transfers through its Pay-with-Transfer service reached ₦1.11 trillion while USSD use fell.

NATIONAL PAYMENT STACK

- **NIBSS National Payment Stack hits 100m transactions** — The Guardian Nigeria, 30 September 2026

  Nigeria's interbank settlement system NIBSS said its ISO 20022-compliant National Payment Stack had passed 100 million successful transactions, as a single rail for banks, microfinance banks, fintechs and mobile money operators.

SMARTCASH PAYMENT SERVICE BANK OWNERSHIP

- **Why Airtel Money's $7bn IPO doesn't include its Nigerian fintech business** — TechCabal, 6 October 2026

Airtel Money's London listing leaves out its Nigerian business. Its prospectus, as reported, says a Central Bank of Nigeria directive required it to transfer its 25% stake in SmartCash back to Airtel's Nigerian network company, for US$3 million; Nigeria made up 1.24% of the unit's quarterly revenue and 6.02% of its customers at June 2026.

BAXI AGENT BANKING NETWORK

- **Onafriq shuts down its Nigerian agent banking business after five years** — TechCabal, 16 October 2026

  Onafriq said on 16 October 2026 that it is closing Baxi, its Nigerian agent-banking business, after five years, citing inflation, naira depreciation, rising costs and the growth of instant account-to-account transfers. Baxi agents have been moved to another principal bank, and Onafriq will stay in Nigeria for payments and card issuing.

- **Onafriq tried to sell its Nigerian agent banking business before shutdown** — TechCabal, 19 October 2026

  Onafriq had been negotiating the sale of Baxi, its Nigerian agent-banking business, before it announced a shutdown on 16 October 2026, according to UK-filed accounts approved on 29 July 2026. The accounts record a non-binding memorandum of terms for a full divestment, agency services revenue down 56% to $13.4 million in 2024, and ₦19.9 billion in overdrafts owed to Zenith Bank and Stanbic IBTC.

COWRY CONTACTLESS TRANSIT CARD, LAGOS

- **The hurdles facing contactless payment adoption across Nigeria** — TechCabal, 16 October 2026

  This TechCabal feature asks why tap-to-pay has not caught on in Nigeria although electronic payments are widespread, starting from CashAfrica's 13 October rollout of mobile tap-to-pay across more than 350 Chicken Republic outlets. It sets that against earlier attempts such as PayAttitude in 2015 and Access Bank's Tap to Phone in 2025, and against the Lagos transport Cowry card, which works because tapping is built into boarding.

Rwanda

EKASH INSTANT TRANSFER SERVICE

- **Rwanda's New eKash Payment System Wins Praise, But Users Report Lingering Transfer Glitches** — RADIOTV10, 2 September 2026

  The National Bank of Rwanda reported that its eKash payment and transfer system has carried more than 10.5 million transactions worth over 960 billion Rwandan francs since its national launch on 14 July 2026, with 98.6% completed. Users of interoperable payments rose from 740,787 to 1,971,522 by end-July; some users report failed or delayed transfers, which the central bank says it is tracking daily.

- **BNR Moves to Tackle Delayed eKash Transfers** — KT Press, 9 October 2026

  Rwanda's central bank said it is working with financial institutions on delayed and failed transfers on the national payment switch, with rejections below 2% by September. Active accounts rose from 2.03 million to 10.3 million in a year.

CENTRAL BANK NATIONAL CASHLESS CAMPAIGN

- **Central Bank Takes Aim at Cash as 92% Still Rely on It** — KT Press, 10 September 2026

  The National Bank of Rwanda launched a national cashless campaign, #TwagiyeKashiresi, in Rubavu District on 7-9 September 2026. Its data show 85.3% of Rwandans hold a digital account but 92% still mainly use cash for everyday spending. The campaign promotes eKash, the national interoperable payment system, and moves to Huye and Rusizi later in September.

VALUE ADDED TAX ORDER ON ONLINE SERVICES

- **Rwanda's online VAT regime raises compliance questions early** — The New Times, 15 September 2026

  A New Times commentary on Rwanda's ministerial order on VAT for online services, in force since 29 April 2026, notes that the revenue authority's registration portal was due by 29 July but is not yet running. Under the order, banks must withhold VAT on payments to unregistered suppliers, and the author says the order sets no turnover threshold for non-residents and no reverse charge for business customers.

BANK OF KIGALI DIRECT PARTICIPATION IN CHINA'S CROSS-BORDER INTERBANK PAYMENT SYSTEM

- **Bank of Kigali Joins China's Cross-Border Payments System, First in This Region** — KT Press, 22 September 2026

  Bank of Kigali has joined China's Cross-Border Interbank Payment System as a direct participant, the first bank in Rwanda and the first headquartered in East and Central Africa to do so, under an agreement signed in Xiamen on 8 September 2026. It gives the bank direct renminbi clearing and settlement without intermediary banks.

DIGITAL AGRICULTURAL LENDING PLATFORM

- **Rwanda is Testing Digital Platform to Get Small Farmers Loans in 48 Hours - KT PRESS** — KT Press, 8 October 2026

  Rwanda's central bank is piloting a digital agricultural lending platform meant to cut farmers' wait for a loan from five to seven weeks to under 48 hours. The six-month pilot began in September 2026 with two microfinance institutions and two banks; a national rollout is planned for 2027.

GHANA-RWANDA CROSS-BORDER PAYMENT INTEROPERABILITY PILOT

- **Bank of Ghana pilots digital cross-border payments with Rwanda, Nigeria** — Ghana News Agency, 13 October 2026 GHANA NIGERIA

  The Bank of Ghana is testing cross-border payments using central bank digital currencies, stablecoins, bank accounts and mobile wallets in its corridors with Rwanda and Nigeria, Governor Johnson Asiama said at the IMF and World Bank annual meetings in Bangkok on 13 October 2026. It has also opened the Pan-African Payment and Settlement System to mobile wallets in the Ghana-Nigeria corridor.

- **Ghana, Rwanda, Nigeria test new cross-border digital payment systems** — Graphic Online, 14 October 2026 GHANA NIGERIA

  Bank of Ghana Governor Johnson Asiama said on 13 October that the bank is testing cross-border payment interoperability with Rwanda and Nigeria across CBDCs, stablecoins, bank accounts and mobile wallets, with the aim of moving to live services on rails such as PAPSS. He said Ghana's mobile money transactions passed one billion in a month for the first time in August 2026, worth GH₵519 billion, and reported fraud cases rose 48% in 2025.

NATIONAL INSTANT PAYMENT SYSTEM

- **Rwanda's eKash Instant Payment System Sees Explosive Growth** — Global Finance Magazine, 15 October 2026

  The National Bank of Rwanda's governor told the IMF-World Bank annual meetings that Rwanda made all person-to-person transfers go through its eKash instant payment system and capped their fee at 20 Rwandan francs. Payments within the EAC go through the regional payment system and those beyond it through PAPSS, and a pilot linking eKash to Tanzania's TIPS is under way. The article's monthly transaction figures disagree with the central bank's own.

Senegal

SHARE OF MONETARY-UNION ELECTRONIC MONEY AND MICROFINANCE ASSETS

- **Monnaie électronique dans l'UEMOA – le Sénégal concentre 29,7 % des actifs et occupe la première place** — Digital Mag Côte d'Ivoire, 1 September 2026 WEST AFRICA

  Senegal held 29.7% of electronic money outstanding in the West African Economic and Monetary Union at the end of 2025, and 26.5% of large microfinance institutions' assets, according to the union's Banking Commission. E-money outstanding across the union rose 35.2% to CFAF 1,923.2 billion, and 64.9% of its 172.9 million e-money accounts were inactive.

DEVELOPMENT BANK AND TELECOMS GROUP DIGITAL FINANCE PROGRAMME FOR WOMEN-LED BUSINESSES

- **African Development Bank and AXIAN Launch Digital Finance Programme to Support 34,000 Women-led Businesses in Africa** — African Development Bank Group (distributed by APO Group), 2 September 2026 MADAGASCAR TANZANIA TOGO COMOROS SUB-SAHARAN AFRICA

  The African Development Bank and AXIAN Group launched a programme on 2 September 2026 to offer digital loans and financial services through AXIAN's Mixx and MVola mobile money platforms to 34,000 women-led small businesses in Madagascar, Tanzania and Senegal. A second component will train 25,000 women in those countries plus Togo and the Comoros. No committed amount is stated.

- **AfDB, AXIAN Take Digital Finance to 34,000 Women-led Businesses in Africa** — Ecofin Agency, 4 September 2026 MADAGASCAR TANZANIA TOGO COMOROS

  The African Development Bank and AXIAN launched a programme to reach 34,000 women-led small businesses in Madagascar, Tanzania and Senegal with loans and financial services through AXIAN's Mixx and MVola mobile-money platforms, with training for 25,000 women in five countries. It follows a US$160m AfDB loan to AXIAN Telecom approved in January 2025, alongside a US$2.5m grant.

SENTRÉSOR STATE PAYMENTS PLATFORM

- **La CSS annonce le paiement des prestations sociales par un opérateur de monnaie électronique** — Agence de Presse Sénégalaise (APS), 2 September 2026

  Senegal's social security fund (Caisse de Sécurité Sociale) announced on 2 September 2026 that beneficiaries can receive social benefits directly into a Wave mobile-money account. Recipients sign up with a form available at CSS branches or on its website. No beneficiary numbers or start date are given.

- **La Caisse de Sécurité Sociale ouvre la voie au paiement via Wave** — Socialnetlink, 19 September 2026

  Senegal's Social Security Fund, CSS, began paying several benefits through the Wave mobile money service, including family allowances, prenatal and postnatal allowances, and maternity and pension payments below 100,000 FCFA. Beneficiaries must enrol using a form available at agencies or online. The fund also opened a customer contact centre with a free number, 800 222 222.

LICENSED PAYMENT INSTITUTIONS

- **Mobile money : Pourquoi le duel Orange Money – Wave ne résume plus le marché** — Seneweb, 23 September 2026

  Seneweb argues Senegal's digital-payments market is no longer an Orange Money-Wave duopoly: under the BCEAO's January 2024 payment-services instruction, licensed payment institutions can now run payment services without being banks or e-money issuers. Of 31 such institutions licensed in the WAEMU by end-February 2026, 11 were in Senegal.

INSTANT PAYMENT PLATFORM PARTICIPATION

- **Wave rejoint la plateforme de paiement instantané de la BCEAO, un an après son lancement** — Agence Ecofin, 1 October 2026 WEST AFRICA

  Mobile money operator Wave Digital Finance appears on the BCEAO's list of participants in its PI-SPI instant payment platform updated on 30 September 2026, authorised to offer the service in Senegal. Wave was absent when the platform launched a year earlier with 45 participants; the list now has 175 across the eight WAEMU states. The central bank had set 30 September 2026 as the connection deadline.

Seychelles

PRE-ARRANGED POST-DISASTER CASH TRANSFERS ON THE SOCIAL PROTECTION REGISTRY

- **Seychelles signs cash transfer pact to boost climate preparedness** — Seychelles Nation, 9 September 2026

  Seychelles' finance ministry and the Agency for Social Protection signed a performance agreement under the regional REPAIR programme, reported on 9 September 2026, to make rapid cash transfers to households after floods, landslides or tsunamis. The agency will pay through its existing beneficiary registry and payment systems and add newly affected households. No value is stated.

Sierra Leone

SMART GOODS AND SERVICES TAX MACHINES

- **NRA Begins Nationwide Distribution of Smart GST Machines to 10,000 Businesses** — The Calabash Newspaper, 2 September 2026

  Sierra Leone's National Revenue Authority began distributing Smart GST machines to 10,000 GST-registered businesses nationwide, announced on 31 August 2026. Commissioner-General Abu Martin Kanneh said the machines complement the existing electronic cash register system and will let businesses issue valid receipts. No cost or supplier is given.

PENSION AND SOCIAL SECURITY SELF-SERVICE APPLICATION

- **NASSIT Set to Launch New Mobile App for Pensioners** — Sierra Loaded, 7 September 2026

  Sierra Leone's social security trust is to launch a self-service application for pensioners and contributors, with a short-code fallback for feature phones, biometric verification and integration with the three mobile-money services. It is announced rather than launched, with no date published.

South Africa

RETAIL ACQUISITION OF AN INFORMAL-TRADE PAYMENTS NETWORK

- **R&A Cellular deal closes: Shoprite takes 51% stake** — TechCentral, 1 September 2026

  The group's results disclose that the R&A Cellular acquisition closed with effect from 14 August 2026 and that the initial stake is 51%. Financial terms remain undisclosed and the initial accounting for the combination is incomplete.

- **Shoprite targets informal retail with fintech expansion** — ITWeb, 1 September 2026

  Shoprite finalised the acquisition of an initial 51% of R&A Cellular, whose point-of-sale platform is used by informal retailers to sell prepaid airtime, electricity, gaming and entertainment — extending the retailer's financial services into South Africa's informal economy.

DIGITAL-ONLY BANK RESULTS

- **Discovery Bank hits R370m profit, clients near 2m** — ITWeb South Africa, 4 September 2026

  Discovery Bank, South Africa's digital-only bank, reported a R370 million normalised operating profit for the year to 30 June 2026, reversing a R68 million loss. Client numbers rose 26% to 1.57 million and revenue 31% to R3.1 billion; it targets R3 billion annual profit by 2029 and launches on 1 October the second phase of a strategy connecting the group's banking, health, insurance and investment businesses through AI-driven personalisation in one app.

PAYMENTS ECOSYSTEM MODERNISATION CREDENTIAL AND WALLET

- **South Africa is rebuilding the machinery behind its payments system** — TechCabal, 10 September 2026

  South Africa is rebuilding both the rules of participation in its payments system and the infrastructure underneath, three payments executives said at a Johannesburg roundtable. A proposed activity-based regulatory model would let non-banks and fintechs offer payment services directly rather than through a sponsoring bank, alongside richer payment data and faster cross-border rails.

PAYMENTS GROUP RETURN TO PROFIT

- **Lesaka turns first profit since its Net 1 rebrand** — ITWeb South Africa, 10 September 2026

  A South African payments group reported a net profit of R47.3 million for the year to June 2026 against a loss of R1.63 billion a year earlier. Its executive chairman called it full-year profitability for the first time since the group was created in 2022 out of a predecessor company; the results accompany a brand refresh.

CASHLESS MUNICIPAL SERVICE OFFICES, CAPE TOWN

- **Cape Town pilots 'cashless' driving licence centres** — ITWeb South Africa, 11 September 2026

  The City of Cape Town will pilot cashless payments at three of its 18 driving licence testing centres, in Brackenfell, Fish Hoek and Strand, from 1 October 2026. Mayoral committee member JP Smith said the pilot will test feasibility across all centres. The city began cashless payments at its customer interaction centres and vehicle licensing offices in July.

ZARP RAND STABLECOIN

- **Local stablecoins are great, but who really needs them?** — TechCabal, 21 September 2026 NIGERIA TANZANIA KENYA AFRICA

  An analysis arguing that stablecoins tied to African currencies have a weak case for retail use, because mobile money and bank transfers already work at home. It sees more promise in wholesale use and currency exchange on the blockchain. It gives supply as of 21 September 2026: about R74.6 million of ZARP in circulation and more than ₦3.75 billion of cNGN.

BANK ZERO ALLIANCE-BANKING PLATFORM

- **South Africa's Bank Zero breaks even as partnerships fuel growth** — TechCabal, 22 September 2026

  App-only Bank Zero recorded its first break-even month in August 2026, five years after opening, with 275,000 direct customers and about 500,000 more through partner platforms. Its CEO put the cost of building its own platform at under R300 million, against an estimated R3 billion to buy one.

ZARU RAND-BACKED STABLECOIN

- **South Africa's ZARU Stablecoin Goes Live on Arc With ZAR/USDC Onchain FX Pair** — Tech Africa News, 22 September 2026

A second report of the ZARU launch on Arc adds how trades settle: the ZARU/USDC pair clears through StableFX's request-for-quote engine, with both legs settling together or not at all, which is meant to remove counterparty risk from rand foreign exchange.

- **ZARU goes live on Circle's Arc blockchain** — ITWeb South Africa, 22 September 2026

  ZAR Universal (ZARU), a rand stablecoin issued by BlockTower under a Financial Sector Conduct Authority licence, went live on Circle's Arc blockchain and opened as a founding currency pair on Circle StableFX. Each token is backed by one rand held in South Africa, with reserves managed by Sanlam Specialised Asset Management; Luno, EasyEquities and Lesaka are partners in its development.

ONSITE CARD CHECKOUT FOR SHOPIFY MERCHANTS

- **Paystack Launches South Africa's First Onsite Card Checkout for Shopify** — Tech Africa News, 25 September 2026

  Paystack introduced an onsite card checkout for Shopify merchants in South Africa, letting shoppers pay by card without leaving the merchant's checkout. It also added a Shopify integration for its in-store Paystack Terminal.

ABSA DIGITAL ASSET CUSTODY

- **Absa sets digital asset custody milestone** — ITWeb Africa, 30 September 2026

  Absa launched institutional digital-asset custody for South African clients on 21 September on Ripple's technology, the first such service by an African bank. It is for institutional and large corporate clients, not retail crypto.

WISE FOREIGN EXCHANGE AUTHORISATION

- **Afrique du Sud : la société financière Wise agréée par la Banque centrale** — wearetech.africa, 16 October 2026

  UK money-transfer firm Wise has received category 2 authorisation from the South African Reserve Bank to deal in foreign exchange and send money abroad under regulation. The approval date is not given; Wise already partners with Capitec.

SARS TAX AND CUSTOMS PAYMENT CHANNELS

- **Guide to SARS Payment Rules** — South African Revenue Service, 17 October 2026

  South Africa's revenue service sets out the rules taxpayers must follow when paying it, by each payment channel, so that payments are allocated correctly. It warns that payments that do not follow the rules may be rejected.

South Sudan

MOBILE MONEY SERVICES (MTN MOMO, DIGITEL)

- **MTN, Government Discuss Reopening of MoMo Services** — Access Radio, 8 October 2026

  South Sudan's caretaker trade minister Labanya Margaret Mathya held a virtual meeting with MTN's senior management on reopening Mobile Money transactions, connectivity problems and digital banking, and said the government would urgently address the company's difficulties. The report does not say when or why Mobile Money transactions were halted.

Sudan

OUTAGE OF THE DOMINANT MOBILE PAYMENT APPLICATION

- **Sudan pound hits 7,000 as banking system falters - The Sudan Times** — The Sudan Times, 3 September 2026

  Bankak, Sudan's main mobile payment app run by the Bank of Khartoum, failed with other digital banking platforms on 2 September 2026 as the pound reached 7,000 to the US dollar on the parallel market. The bank apologised and said its teams were restoring service. Bakeries, petrol stations and other businesses turned away customers who could not pay electronically.

- **حملة لمقاطعة تطبيق بنكك.. دعوات لسحب الأموال وتحويل العملاء إلى بنوك سودانية أخرى** — Akher Khabar, 9 September 2026

  A social-media campaign in Sudan urged Bank of Khartoum customers to boycott its Bankak app, withdraw their money and move to Family Bank, Savings Bank or Omdurman National Bank, citing repeated app outages. Posts also claimed the bank had stopped transfers to other banks and alleged Emirati shareholding; the report notes neither claim carries independent documentation or official confirmation.

- **Bankak outages disrupt Sudan's digital payments and markets** — Dabanga Radio TV Online, 10 September 2026

  Repeated outages on Bank of Khartoum's Bankak app and Faisal Islamic Bank's Fawry service disrupted transfers, payments and trade in Sudan between late August and early September 2026, pushing demand back to cash, Radio Dabanga reported on 10 September. A banking expert said some traders now accept only cash; an IT consultant called on the Central Bank of Sudan to lead a national interoperable payment system.

- **"لا وصول للأموال".. عندما يتعطل أهم تطبيق "بنكي" بالسودان** — Al Arabiya, 9 October 2026

  Outages of Bank of Khartoum's Bankak app left Sudanese customers unable to reach or transfer money during cash and fuel shortages, Al Arabiya reported on 9 October 2026. Sudan's energy and oil ministry blamed fuel-station queues partly on slow banking apps, and a speaker warned of losses to government collection through the Eesaly system. The bank apologised and said its teams were working round the clock.

FRAMEWORK AGREEMENT FOR MOBILE POS REVENUE-COLLECTION DEVICES

- **اتفاق جديد لتوريد أجهزة تحصيل إلكتروني محمولة** — Suda News, 11 September 2026

  Sudan's Federal Ministry of Finance signed a framework agreement with 11 companies to bid in restricted tenders to supply mobile point-of-sale devices for collecting public revenue in state institutions. IT director-general Lamia Mohamed Nour described the devices as a secure way to collect revenue. No contract value, signing date or delivery schedule is given.

COMMISSION CHARGED TO CONVERT TRANSFERS INTO CASH

- **Cash crisis eats into humanitarian aid in East Darfur** — The Sudan Times, 14 September 2026

  Families receiving humanitarian aid in Sudan's East Darfur are losing 40% to 45% of payments to fees for converting Bankak app transfers into cash, amid a banknote shortage and traders' refusal of electronic payment. A displaced mother in El Daein received 780,000 Sudanese pounds and collected 468,000.

- **أزمة في الكاش بالخرطوم وارتفاع نسبة التبديل عبر التطبيقات البنكية** — Sudan Independent, 16 September 2026

  The commission for exchanging bank-app balances such as Bankak for cash has risen to as much as 10% in Sudan's Khartoum State amid a cash shortage and restrictions on several banking apps, Sudan Independent reported on 16 September 2026, citing Darfur24. Most dealers charge 5%. Locals said the dollar rose from about 6,150 Sudanese pounds in early September to about 8,000.

SINGLE-PRICE DIRECTIVE FOR CASH AND APP PAYMENTS IN RSF-HELD AREAS

- **Dagalo orders unified cash, digital payment prices in Darfur** — The Sudan Times, 15 September 2026

  Rapid Support Forces commander Mohamed Hamdan Dagalo ordered traders in RSF-held areas of Sudan to charge one price whether customers pay in cash or through the Bankak app, a Future Bank manager in East Darfur said. The gap between cash and electronic prices had reached about 40% in some markets. Government bodies in those areas were told to stop collecting payments through Bankak and use Future Bank instead.

ISALI / EISALI (ELECTRONIC GOVERNMENT-COLLECTION SYSTEM)

- **Finance Ministry Signs SMS Service Agreement with MTN Sudan** — Sudan Horizon, 27 September 2026

  Sudan's Ministry of Finance signed an agreement with MTN Sudan to provide SMS services for Eesaly, the state electronic collection and payment system, the ministry said on 27 September 2026. Citizens with MTN SIM cards will be able to use Eesaly services and track their transactions by text message. No cost or start date is given.

- **Finance Ministry Signs SMS Service Agreement with Zain Telecommunications** — Sudan Horizon, 4 October 2026

  Sudan's finance ministry signed an agreement with Zain in Khartoum on 4 October for text-message services on Eisali, the state electronic collection and payment system. Users are to be told the status of each transaction as it is registered, updated or completed.

- **المالية وسوداني يوقعان عقد خدمة الرسائل النصية القصيرة - السودان اليوم** — السودان اليوم, 8 October 2026

  Sudan's Ministry of Finance signed a contract with Sudani Telecom on 8 October 2026 for SMS services supporting Eesaly, the government's electronic collection and payment system, according to the Sudan News Agency. No value or duration is given.

SUDAN PAY DIGITAL MOBILE-PAYMENT AND SWITCHING LICENCE

- **CBoS Revokes Sudan Pay Digital's Mobile Payment License** — Sudan Horizon, 28 September 2026

  The Central Bank of Sudan's governor, Amna Mirghani Hassan Al-Tom, revoked Sudan Pay Digital's licence for mobile payments and financial transaction switching by Administrative Decision No. 65 of 2026, issued on 28 September. The decision cites the Banking Business Regulation Act of 2026 and payment regulations; no reason is given.

BALADNA BIBASATA USSD BANKING SERVICE

- **خدمة مصرفية بلا إنترنت .. MTN مصرف البلد يطلق "بلدنا ببساطة" بالتعاون مع** — Al-Wijha 24, 6 October 2026

  Sudan's Albalad Bank launched "Baladna Bibasata" in Khartoum, a USSD banking service built with MTN Sudan that needs neither internet nor a smartphone. It is aimed in particular at letting humanitarian organisations pay beneficiaries. Its technical partner, Smart Solutions, said it is the first step towards a services platform modelled on M-Pesa. The launch date is not stated.

BANKAK (BANK OF KHARTOUM MOBILE MONEY)

- **بنكك من تعثر التطبيق إلى التحويل هِبْن دون إنترنت.. هل ينجح في احتواء الأزمة؟** — الرؤية نيوز, 10 October 2026

  Bank of Khartoum has opened a USSD transfer service on MTN lines, so customers can move money without a smartphone or a data connection. It comes as complaints about outages of the bank's app continue; the bank says more services will follow on the same channel.

BEDE DIGITAL WALLET (ZAIN)

- **Bede Sudan Launches BBAN Service to Strengthen Banking Integration and Expand Digital Transaction** — Sudan Horizon, 13 October 2026

  Bede Sudan, a mobile operator's fintech arm, launched a bank account number service that links its digital wallet to the banking system, with a commercial bank and central bank approval. Wallet users can send and receive funds across all Sudanese banks.

Tanzania

ACTIVE MOBILE MONEY SUBSCRIPTIONS

- **Mobile money surge fuels cashless growth** — The Citizen, 1 September 2026

  Active mobile money subscriptions in Tanzania reached 87.05 million in June 2026, up 7.5%, on the communications regulator's figures.

DEVELOPMENT BANK AND TELECOMS GROUP DIGITAL FINANCE PROGRAMME FOR WOMEN-LED BUSINESSES

- **African Development Bank and AXIAN Launch Digital Finance Programme to Support 34,000 Women-led Businesses in Africa** — African Development Bank Group (distributed by APO Group), 2 September 2026
  MADAGASCAR SENEGAL TOGO COMOROS SUB-SAHARAN AFRICA

  The African Development Bank and AXIAN Group launched a programme on 2 September 2026 to offer digital loans and financial services through AXIAN's Mixx and MVola mobile money platforms to 34,000 women-led small businesses in Madagascar, Tanzania and Senegal. A second component will train 25,000 women in those countries plus Togo and the Comoros. No committed amount is stated.

- **AfDB, AXIAN Take Digital Finance to 34,000 Women-led Businesses in Africa** — Ecofin Agency, 4 September 2026 MADAGASCAR SENEGAL TOGO COMOROS

  The African Development Bank and AXIAN launched a programme to reach 34,000 women-led small businesses in Madagascar, Tanzania and Senegal with loans and financial services through AXIAN's Mixx and MVola mobile-money platforms, with training for 25,000 women in five countries. It follows a US$160m AfDB loan to AXIAN Telecom approved in January 2025, alongside a US$2.5m grant.

DIGITAL PAYMENTS IN THE ZANZIBAR SEAWEED VALUE CHAIN

- **Huduma za malipo kidigitali zawanufaisha wakulima wa mwani Zanzibar** — Mwananchi, 17 September 2026

  A foundation, a mobile money service and a business operator signed a partnership to pay Zanzibar's seaweed farmers — most of them women — digitally and to extend savings, contribution and group-lending services to them. The operator supplies connectivity and the registration, reporting and monitoring systems for the foundation's wider programmes.

ZED360 SCHOOL-FEES PLATFORM

- **KCB rolls out digital school-fees platform nationwide** — The Citizen, 18 September 2026

  KCB Bank Tanzania began a nationwide rollout of Zed360, a school-fees platform acquired with its purchase of fintech RiverBank, with 18 schools using it, The Citizen reported on 18 September 2026. Each student gets an invoice or control number linked to school records, and Mixx by Yas agents also collect payments. Managing director Cosmas Kimario said Zanzibar is included in the plan.

CENTRAL ELECTRONIC TICKETING SYSTEM

- **Tanzania: Cash Still King in Public Transport Despite Four-Year Digital Push** — Tanzania Daily News (via allAfrica), 25 September 2026

> Of 62.18 million passengers recorded through online ticketing in Tanzania's public transport over four years, 95.3 per cent paid cash and 4.7 per cent paid digitally, the Land Transport Regulatory Authority's director general Habibu Suluo said. Electronic payments made up TSh144.28 billion of TSh2.13 trillion collected, or 6.8 per cent, although the law requires electronic payment for several services.

> ZANZIBAR HEALTH SERVICE FUND ENROLMENT AND COLLECTION MEMORANDUM WITH A BANK

- **KCB, Zanzibar health fund expand healthcare access** — The Guardian (Tanzania), 5 October 2026

  KCB Bank Tanzania and the Zanzibar Health Service Fund signed a memorandum of understanding on 5 October 2026. It covers member registration and enrolment, payment collection, banking and settlement services, and technology integration for the fund. No financial terms are given.

> DIGITAL CHANNELS IN SAVINGS AND CREDIT COOPERATIVES

- **PM calls for digital shift as women's representation in SACCOS rises - Daily News** — Daily News, 15 October 2026

  Opening the SACCA Congress in Dar es Salaam on 15 October 2026, Prime Minister Mwigulu Nchemba said Tanzania's SACCOS run 231 mobile-money agency arrangements and five offer mobile apps, with about 119,000 app and USSD users and 3.5 million transactions. He said only just over one in four SACCOS has a core banking system, and cited 72% adult mobile-money use from the 2023 financial inclusion report.

> PAPSS ACCESS THROUGH A COMMERCIAL BANK

- **UBA launches pan-African payment system to ease cross-border transactions** — The Citizen (Mwananchi Communications), 16 October 2026

  UBA Tanzania has launched cross-border payments over the Pan-African Payment and Settlement System and says it is the first bank in Tanzania to sign up. Its customers can pay into other participating countries from shilling accounts at branches or through WhatsApp and Facebook, for a 2.5% fee capped at US$20, up to US$5,000 a transfer and US$10,000 a day.

> MOOVNPAY WALLET ACCEPTANCE THROUGH MASTERCARD PAY LOCAL

- **Mastercard and Moovn sign five-year deal to expand digital payments across East Africa** — TechAfrica News, 19 October 2026 KENYA

  Mastercard and Moovn Technologies signed a five-year agreement, announced on 19 October 2026, to add Mastercard prepaid cards, tokenisation, online acceptance, Pay Local and cross-border transfers to the MoovnPay wallet. Pay Local is to expand across Kenya and Tanzania, and the Shooga prepaid Mastercard portfolio is to launch next.

Togo

> CERTIFIED ELECTRONIC INVOICING

- **Togo's Tax Authority, Employers Discuss Certified E-Invoicing Reform** — Togo First, 14 September 2026

  About 50 businesses met Togo's revenue office on 10 September on the certified electronic invoicing introduced by the 2026 budget law. Each invoice will carry a unique number, QR code and digital fingerprint; firms may use the office's solution or connected software, and paper invoices stay valid until a gradual launch.

> DIGITAL BUS TICKETING ON THE PUBLIC TRANSPORT NETWORK

- **After Student Pilot, Togo Plans Wider Rollout of Digital Bus Ticketing** — Togo First, 15 September 2026

Togo's public bus operator SOTRAL plans to extend digital ticketing across its network by the end of 2026, after a pilot on routes serving University of Lomé students. The transport ministry is finalising the project with operator Yas Togo, including USSD ticket purchase by phone, while SOTRAL standardises fares. SOTRAL carries nearly 26,000 passengers a day.

E-TPU ONLINE DECLARATION AND PAYMENT OF THE SINGLE BUSINESS TAX

- **La plateforme de déclaration et de paiement en ligne de la Taxe professionnelle unique (e-TPU) officiellement lancée** — Office Togolais des Recettes, 17 September 2026

  Togo's finance ministry and revenue office OTR launched e-TPU in Lomé on 17 September 2026, a platform for filing and paying the single business tax paid by small firms, artisans and traders. It is open around the clock, calculates the tax automatically and takes payment by mobile money, including Flooz and Mixx by Yas. Users can see their deadlines and tax history.

- **OTR : la plateforme e-TPU lancée pour les PME et PMI / Le secteur privé salue un gain de temps majeur** — Ministère des Finances et du Budget (Togo), 17 September 2026

  Togo's revenue office OTR launched e-TPU, a platform for filing and paying the single business tax online from a mobile phone, at a ceremony chaired by finance minister Essowè Georges Barcola. The minister said it ends paper declarations and told OTR to run a change-management plan so that no one is excluded. The national employers' council and artisans' chambers backed the platform.

ONLINE TAX DECLARATION AND PAYMENT FOR LARGE AND MEDIUM ENTERPRISES

- **Togo Moves Single Business Tax Filing and Payments Online** — Togo First, 17 September 2026

  Togo's revenue office opened online filing and payment of the single business tax, the first time the declaration and payment steps have been available without a visit to a tax office. The six-step procedure runs from the taxpayer's identification number to a QR-coded receipt, is designed for a basic handset and connection, accepts three mobile money services, and targets artisans, traders and microenterprises on the flat-rate regime.

Tunisia

SIBTEL CLEARING, THE SMT CARD SYSTEM AND THE SGMT SETTLEMENT SYSTEM

- **Systèmes de paiement — Banque Centrale de Tunisie (Système de la Télécompensation, compensation manuelle, système de la Monétique, SGMT)** — Banque Centrale de Tunisie, 3 September 2026

  Tunisia's central bank describes the country's payment systems on its website: SIBTEL clearing for transfers, direct debits, cheques and bills of exchange with 24-hour settlement; the SMT card system and its secure online payment service; and the SGMT real-time gross settlement system. The SGMT, in service since November 2006, handles about 722 payments a day worth 3.255 billion dinars. The page carries no publication date.

FREE DIGITAL WALLETS FOR SCHOOL AND UNIVERSITY REGISTRATION

- **Numérisation : La Poste Tunisienne valide plus de 1,8 million d'inscriptions scolaires et universitaires en ligne - La Presse de Tunisie** — La Presse de Tunisie, 9 October 2026

  La Poste Tunisienne said about 1.57 million pupils, some 75%, and about 287,300 university students, some 76%, paid their 2026–2027 registration fees online using its free e-Dinar wallets. The post office also brought a new integrated ERP system into operation and launched the Universal Postal Union's Ecom@africa e-commerce exchange platform at Tunis-Carthage airport.

Uganda

KAMPALA-ENTEBBE EXPRESSWAY TOLL COLLECTION

- **Mobile Money Toll Payments Coming to Kampala-Entebbe Expressway** — ChimpReports, 11 September 2026

  Uganda's Ministry of Works and Transport said on 10 September 2026 that test runs of mobile money toll payment on the Kampala-Entebbe Expressway were complete, with dedicated lanes to follow. It did not say which platforms, what charges or when. Parliament's infrastructure committee is examining the reported UGX 122 billion five-year toll operation contract with Egis.

- **MTN Uganda Launches Mobile Money Toll Payments on Kampala-Entebbe Expressway** — Tech Africa News, 25 September 2026

  MTN Uganda and the Ministry of Works and Transport launched Mobile Money toll payment on the Kampala-Entebbe Expressway, at the Busega, Kajjansi and Mpala plazas on designated lanes. The motorist gives a phone number to the attendant and approves a PIN prompt; no fee was named.

EACBOND REGIONAL CUSTOMS GUARANTEE

- **Afreximbank issues a $29 million guarantee to scale EAC Customs Bond, easing movement of goods across East Africa** — African Export-Import Bank (Afreximbank), 22 September 2026 EAST AFRICA

  Afreximbank issued a US$29m guarantee to BSMART Technology on 22 September 2026 to scale the EAC Customs Bond, a digital regional customs guarantee that removes the need to post paper bonds at each border. The bond was piloted from August 2025 and launched at the East African Community heads of state summit in March 2026.

PRIDE BANK SERVICES ON THE INTERSWITCH AGENT AND CARD NETWORK

- **Pride Bank and Interswitch join forces to deliver easier, accessible banking solutions to customers** — The Independent (Uganda), 22 September 2026

  Uganda's Pride Bank launched a partnership with Interswitch that offers selected banking services through Interswitch's network of more than 21,000 Quickteller agents and issues Pride Bank Verve debit cards. Agents will handle deposits, withdrawals, loan repayments and bill payments. No financial terms are given.

Zambia

AUTOMATED MONITORING OF MOBILE MONEY AGENT ACTIVITY AND LIQUIDITY

- **African mobile money shifts beyond adoption** — TechTrendsKE, 4 September 2026 GHANA

  MTN mobile money executives told the group's fintech summit in Johannesburg that high adoption numbers mask weak use of savings and investment products. The Ghanaian chief executive said the platform processes more than 26 million transactions a day but that fewer than 0.3% of users actively invest; the Zambian chief executive said agent numbers were not on their own solving access and that the company had deployed artificial intelligence to monitor agent activity and liquidity to find where customers cannot get cash.

MOBILE-MONEY CASH-OUT AT A COMMERCIAL BANK'S ATMS

- **MoMo, FNB launch Zambia ATM cash-out** — ITWeb Africa, 17 September 2026

  MTN MoMo and FNB launched a service in Zambia letting mobile-money customers withdraw from their wallets at the bank's ATMs without a card or an account at that bank. It extends a partnership that already carried transfers between wallets and bank accounts and wallet payments at the bank's terminals.

DIRECT RENMINBI SETTLEMENT THROUGH CIPS (STANBIC BANK ZAMBIA)

- **Zambia says RMB payment system can cut trade costs, deepen China investment** — Zambia Monitor, 23 September 2026

  Stanbic Bank Zambia launched direct renminbi settlement for Zambia–China trade through China's Cross-Border Interbank Payment System in Lusaka on 23 September 2026. Zambia's commerce permanent secretary Lillian Bwalya said it would cut currency-conversion and intermediary costs and support Chinese investment in mining, manufacturing and infrastructure.

ZAMPAY AND THE GOVERNMENT ELECTRONIC PAYMENT GATEWAY

- **Zamportal revenue crosses $500m mark** — ITWeb Africa, 1 October 2026

  Zambia's finance minister said the national services portal has collected about K9.8 billion across 572 services and 52 providers since 2019. The 2027-2029 budget call circular names the Government Service Bus and payment gateway as the state's centralised revenue-collection system.

Zimbabwe

INTERMEDIATED MONEY TRANSFER TAX (IMTT)

- **Zimbabwe: Country Growth and Jobs Report (P512930)** — World Bank Group, 2 September 2026

  The World Bank's Country Growth and Jobs Report for Zimbabwe recommends considering phasing out the 2% Intermediate Money Transfer Tax, beginning with ZiG transactions. It records mobile money use by 63% of the population and digital retail transactions of USD 5.9 billion in the second quarter of 2025, and notes the January 2026 cut of the ZiG rate to 1.5%.

- **World Bank warns Zim** — Business Times (Zimbabwe), 17 September 2026

  The World Bank has urged Zimbabwe to reform its Intermediated Money Transfer Tax, saying the levy on electronic transactions discourages digital payments, weakens financial intermediation and pushes activity towards cash, Business Times reported on 17 September 2026. Banks and businesses are calling for the tax to be abolished or cut. Only the article's opening paragraph is available.

FREQUENT TRAVELLER EXPRESS PASS TOLL PRE-PAYMENT

- **Checking Your ZINARA Frequent Traveller Express Pass (FTEP) Balance** — TechnoMag, 3 September 2026

  The Zimbabwe National Roads Administration lets holders of its Frequent Traveller Express Pass, a prepaid toll facility, check their remaining trips on WhatsApp by sending 'Zinara' and the vehicle registration number to +263 771 288 940. The pass is for drivers using toll plazas at least 15 times a month, who buy bundles of 15 to 25 trips.

DIGITAL FOREIGN-EXCHANGE TRADING SYSTEM

- **Zimbabwe says single-currency switch hinges on market conditions** — NewZimbabwe (Bloomberg), 16 September 2026

  The Reserve Bank of Zimbabwe will introduce a digital foreign exchange trading system in the fourth quarter of 2026 after World Bank peer review, governor John Mushayavanhu told bankers in Harare. He said the move to the ZiG as sole currency will depend on single-digit inflation and three to six months of import cover; cover currently stands at about 1.8 months.

INVOICEX INVOICE-DISCOUNTING MARKETPLACE

- **Zimbabwe Stock Exchange launches InvoiceX 48-hour invoice discounting market** — BCR Publishing, 24 September 2026

> The Zimbabwe Stock Exchange opened InvoiceX, a regulated invoice-discounting market run under the Zimbabwe Entrepreneurship Exchange, for invoices of US$1,000 to US$1.5 million. Once a buyer authenticates an invoice, licensed banks and microfinance lenders bid on the discount rate, with supplier payment targeted within 48 hours and platform fees of 0.65% of the transaction.

> REAL-TIME PAYMENTS SYSTEM ON INDIA'S UPI TECHNOLOGY

- **Zimbabwe eyes India’s UPI tech for national payments network; NPCI talks may wrap by October 31** — Moneycontrol, 6 October 2026

  Zimbabwe's central bank is negotiating with NPCI International to build a real-time payments system on India's UPI technology, linking banks, mobile-money operators and fintechs. The governor told Bloomberg an agreement is possible by 31 October 2026; cross-border payments and remittances are not part of the first deployment.

> PAN-AFRICAN PAYMENT AND SETTLEMENT SYSTEM PARTICIPATION

- **CEO Africa Roundtable: Zimbabwe processes $5.8 million a month through PAPSS as local currency settlement takes hold** — The Herald, 8 October 2026

  Afreximbank said Zimbabwe is processing US$5.8 million a month through the pan-African payment and settlement system. Yuan clearing is being brought onto the platform through its link to China's interbank system.

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